

# biola

MAGAZINE

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*The Magazine of Biola University*  
SPRING 2017



## *A New Day*

*As a historic \$214 million campaign closes,  
Biola embarks on a bold new chapter*

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for all students*

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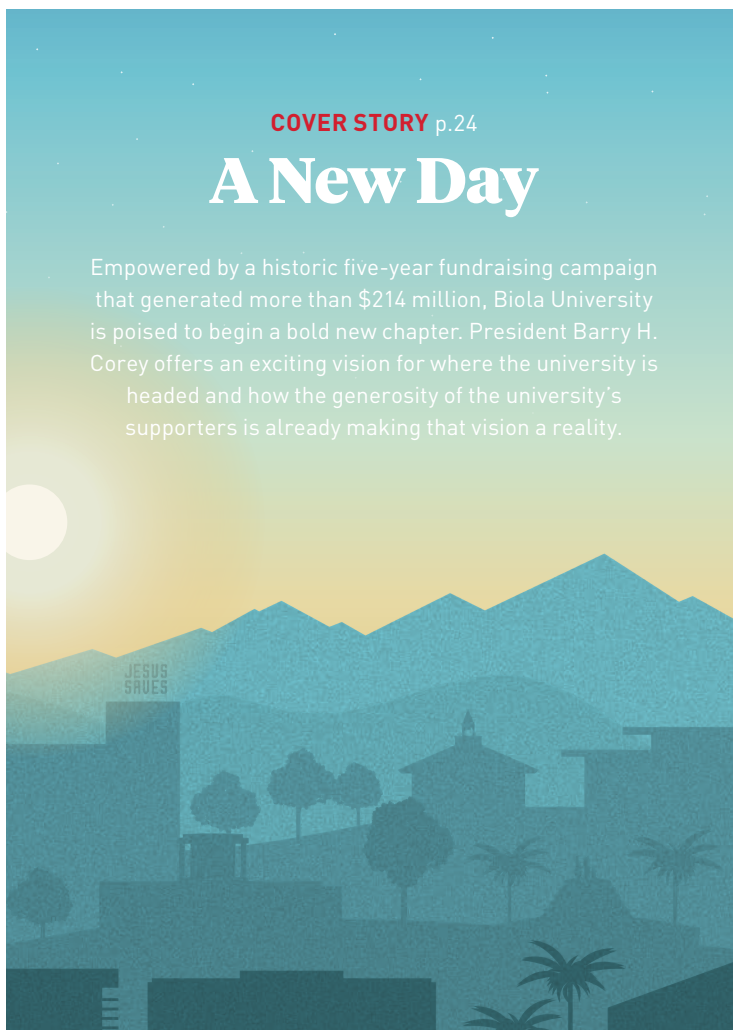
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## A New Day

Empowered by a historic five-year fundraising campaign that generated more than \$214 million, Biola University is poised to begin a bold new chapter. President Barry H. Corey offers an exciting vision for where the university is headed and how the generosity of the university's supporters is already making that vision a reality.



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## How Should Christians Think About Power?

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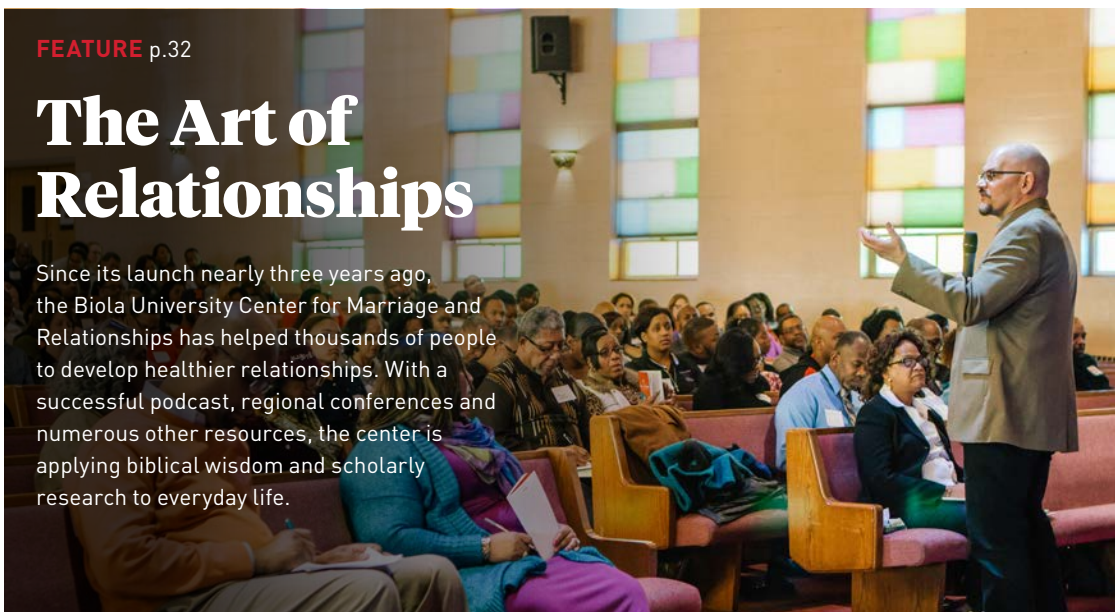
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## The Art of Relationships

Since its launch nearly three years ago, the Biola University Center for Marriage and Relationships has helped thousands of people to develop healthier relationships. With a successful podcast, regional conferences and numerous other resources, the center is applying biblical wisdom and scholarly research to everyday life.



THE LAST WORD p.43

## editor's note

# The Backdrop of a Dawning Day

I'LL ADMIT, I WAS ONE OF THE SKEPTICS. When university leaders announced the launch of an unprecedented \$180 million fundraising campaign five years ago, I inwardly worried that the target had been placed at the wrong end of the continuum between “faith-stretching” and “completely out of reach.”

I was wrong. Five years later, by the grace and provision of God, you did it. More than 20,700 of you came alongside this university and gave generously toward The Campaign for Biola University — not just reaching the goal, but dramatically exceeding it. When the campaign came to its official end in December 2016, you had given more than \$214 million to support the university's vision.

God has faithfully used and led this university since well before any of us were born, and the successful completion of the largest fundraising campaign in Biola's 109-year history is just the latest evidence of how he is guiding us forward.

That's what we've tried to capture in the illustration on our cover, created by graphic designer Rebecca DiMarzio ('12). Turn back and look at it again. Off in the distance, just beneath the rising sun, is the original Bible Institute of Los Angeles building, topped by its famed neon “Jesus Saves” signs. As the Southern California landscape extends forward, so do the iconic landmarks that represent different eras in Biola's history: Calvary Chapel, the Bell Tower, the library, the Fluor Fountain, the business building and Talbot East. Finally, nearest to us in the bottom right corner rests the outline of the soon-to-be-completed Alton and Lydia Lim Center for Science, Technology and Health. In this one image, we see Biola's past, present and future, all against the backdrop of a dawning day.

Through the generosity of so many people in the extended Biola family, this campaign has helped to launch a new day for the university. As you can read about in the cover story from President Barry H. Corey, Biola faces exciting and challenging opportunities in its immediate future. In the coming years, the university is positioned to grow in leadership in the STEM fields, serve an ever-more-diverse community of students, reach thousands of people around the world through new online programs, move into NCAA competition, and produce biblically centered research and teaching on the most important issues facing Christianity and culture.

These are exciting times to be a part of the Biola community — not because we collectively raised \$214 million, but because of what those resources will enable us to accomplish for the sake of God's kingdom. This dawn of a new day is an occasion to step back and praise God for the great things he is doing. As you glance back at the cover, let the words of Psalm 113:3 resound in you: “From the rising of the sun to its setting, the name of the Lord is to be praised.”



Jason Newell ('02, M.A. '13)

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# reader feedback

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*Opinions should be a maximum of 200 words and include full name, city and state, and class year (if applicable). They may be edited for length and clarity.*



## GOVERNMENT THREATS WILL CONTINUE

Although the amendment of Senate Bill 1146 is a slight relief for Christian colleges and universities, one must expect that this is only the beginning of more to come ("Religious Liberty Preserved," Fall 2016). Followers of Christ are increasingly being discriminated against simply for the fact that they desire to believe and act according to Scripture. The sexual/moral revolution has been underway for years and appears to be gaining momentum. One might like to think that if only nonbelievers saw all the good work Christians do or if Christians strengthened their arguments for their beliefs, then the secular world would appreciate the Body of Christ; this notion is risible.

Christians have some of the best arguments out there, most of which have not even been seriously considered by the mainstream secular world; moreover, the church has been engaging in acts of charity, kindness, etc., for thousands of years. The hard truth is that the leftists do not care about this. They hate the God of Scripture and desire to live their lives

autonomously. Not only do they want to live life as they see fit, they seek to silence and hurt anyone, especially Christians, who speak against their sin. ... Proverbs 22:7 states, "The rich rules over the poor and the borrower is slave of the lender." Perhaps it is time for Biola to deeply ponder this verse and the anti-Christian culture that is prevalent in society. One must be prepared for the government to continue attempting to eradicate Christian ideas and value within society. It may be wise for the Biola administration to begin planning ways for the university to cease accepting money from the government so that Biola will not be a slave to the wishes of its master — the federal government.

**ERIC DIAZ ('12)**  
New York, N.Y.



## LIMITATIONS OF APOLOGETICS

Craig Hazen is correct that apologetics is important in sharing the gospel ("Young People are Indeed Leaving the Church," Fall 2016). We need to be ready with an answer to those who ask us.

But even Paul could not convince certain Jews. For when he arrived as a prisoner in Rome, some simply "would not believe" (Acts 28:24). Søren Kierkegaard aptly affirmed this in his book *The Sickness Unto Death*, when he declared that sin lies in the will, not in the intellect. Sometimes we can be very clear in our defense of biblical truths, yet a person will deny Christ simply because he chooses to, and no amount of textual or other type of proof will ever convince him.

**LINDA C. (RICKARDS, '79) BROWN**  
Boise, Idaho



## MORE LISTENING, LESS ARGUING

I received my *Biola Magazine* in the mail this week. It promotes a book by Josh McDowell which is predicated on the idea that cultural acceptance is bad. The next spread contained an article saying that the reason millennials are leaving the church is because of unexpressed doubt and that articulated theology in the form of apologetics is the key to

keeping them. In other words, providing a defense for the faith. This concerns me because it is more of the same sentiment that I saw as a student and the cause of many problems that have surfaced for my peers during the election season, in particular.

Intolerance has caused many of the world's problems, and the answer is listening, not providing more arguments for how Christians get it right. I'm disturbed by the lack of humility in the Christian community lately. I can see how these sentiments might seem reasonable or right within the campus context, but zooming out of that context, does it make sense in the world? The world Christ came to save and not to condemn? My hope is that Biola community members are sincerely seeking the renewal of their minds and hearts, and that humble men and wise women will lead the faculty and staff in the way they should go. I encourage you to be this influence as much as you are able. I do not think promoting intolerance or apologetic defenses (which are very often used on the offensive) will accomplish what Biola hopes to be in the world. Please do not espouse these sentiments.

**BONNIE K. NORLANDER ('04)**  
Portland, Maine

president's perspective

## God's Need in God's Time Will Not Lack God's Supply

**T**he 60 months of our fundraising campaign, “A Soul of Conviction, A Voice of Courage: The Campaign for Biola University,” have been a journey for all of us. The journey has not been simply toward our ambitious goal of \$180 million. Nor has it been primarily a journey of the wonderful relationships built with the 20,730 alumni, friends, parents, students, faculty, staff, foundations, corporations and churches that have invested in Biola over these five years. But it has also been a journey of faith.

On Jan. 21, 2012, in a Carlsbad, Calif., hotel conference room, the Biola University Board of Trustees began to discuss the motion we brought to them: a recommendation to launch a five-year fundraising campaign

nine times bigger than anything we had undertaken in Biola's history. The reality was, we had a vision for the coming few years that would need \$180 million of financial underwriting from the donor community. The reality *also* was that we did not have any certainty of where we would secure these funds. Our incredibly gifted consultants believed that if we stretched, we might be able to launch a campaign of about \$150 million or so. Therein was the gap. It wasn't just that gap that would need to be filled with faith. It was the entire campaign.

As the Board of Trustees that January day deliberated over the motion to launch the campaign with such a stretch goal, an amendment was made. One trustee, sensing the seriousness

and sacredness of this undertaking, added some words to the motion's first sentence: “Be it resolved that *with great confidence in our Lord to do the miraculous in our midst*, the Biola University Board of Trustees approves the launching of a comprehensive campaign with a working goal of \$180 million...”

This captured what we knew was true: We made a decision to embark on a journey of faith. Years before I came to Biola, a wise, older gentleman shared with me that “God's need in God's time will not lack God's supply.” Those 10 words became my prayer, our prayer. This was our prayer during stretches when the needle toward our goal barely moved. This was our prayer when we submitted seven-figure proposals to foundations. This was our prayer when donations we never expected came from donors in proportions that defied our best strategizing. This was our prayer the evening of May 9, 2015, when under the “JESUS SAVES” sign our campaign went public. This was our prayer each time we gathered together or fasted as a community, interceding for this campaign.

Because of the incredible sacrifice and generous giving of so many — including many of you reading this *Biola Magazine* — we began to see that prayer answered and as a result, the university strengthened. (You can read in detail about the tangible impacts and university-wide

momentum created by the campaign in this issue's cover story on page 24.)

On Jan. 28, 2017, five years after the Biola University Board of Trustees passed the motion launching the “A Soul of Conviction, A Voice of Courage” campaign, the board passed a motion to conclude the campaign. Where the January 2012 motion was in anticipation of what God would do, the January 2017 motion was of gratitude for what God had done.

Here is the motion passed unanimously by the board earlier this year:

“With glory attributed to our sovereign Lord, the Biola University Board of Trustees hereby concludes our five-year fundraising campaign, *A Soul of Conviction, A Voice of Courage: The Campaign for Biola University*. Furthermore, as anticipated in the Board's January 2012 motion launching the campaign, we finish this campaign having witnessed the very clear evidence of the *miraculous hand of God in our midst*. Toward the Board-approved campaign goal of \$180,000,000, the Board hereby announces the closure of *The Campaign for Biola University* with final campaign gifts and pledges totaling \$214,184,605. To God be the glory!”

Once again, as has been true for the people of God over the ages, God's need in God's time has not lacked God's supply. Biola's best years are yet to come.



**Barry H. Corey** is the eighth president of Biola University. Visit his office online at [biola.edu/president](http://biola.edu/president), or follow him on Facebook at [facebook.com/presidentcorey](https://facebook.com/presidentcorey), on Instagram @[presidentbarrycorey](https://instagram.com/presidentbarrycorey) and on Twitter @[presidentcorey](https://twitter.com/presidentcorey).



# red report

## News & Views from Biola's Campus

- Virtual reality headsets provide innovative tour of Biola's campus
- Biola's first endowed chair established in honor of William Lane Craig
- Speech-language clinic serves students while serving local children

## New Center Established to Focus on Work of the Holy Spirit

Donor-funded initiative aims for more spiritual transformation and empowerment for evangelism

**W**HAT WOULD HAPPEN IF BIOLA WAS MORE intentional about understanding the work of the Holy Spirit and developing a greater passion to be led by the empowering and life-giving Spirit of God?

This is the question at the heart of the soon-to-be established Center for the Study of the Work and Ministry of the Holy Spirit Today — an academic center with a long-stretching name and a wide-reaching mission. Funded by a generous \$3 million donation, this 10-year initiative will provide resources for a biblical examination of the person and ongoing work of the Holy Spirit, including research, publications, conferences, events and services for students.

The center, which is set for an official launch in the fall of 2017, is envisioned as a home for biblical scholars who wish to provide greater attention to not just a theology of the Holy Spirit but also the awakening and empowering of the Holy Spirit. It will be a training ground for students and faculty who want a greater infusion of the Spirit's enablement to be more effective in evangelism, 



global mission, praying for the sick, bringing deliverance to the oppressed and defeating the power of sin.

In funding the center, the donors, who wished to remain unnamed, noted that Biola has a long tradition of emphasizing the importance of the Word of God, and has long sought to know God through his Word and to obey all that it says, including the Great Commission. The motivation for funding a center at Biola was to balance this with a renewed emphasis on the empowering work of the Holy Spirit, they said.

“Biola wants to learn from the extraordinary ways that the Spirit is working globally and for our students to experience this empowerment to impact the world for the Lord Jesus Christ,” said Clinton E. Arnold, dean of Talbot School of Theology, who has helped to guide the proposal for the center. “We believe that this may indeed be a place where God pours out his Spirit in palpable ways that call

us to bolder lives of obedience and service and evangelism.”

The center will function under the oversight of Talbot School of Theology, and will be housed in a remodeled portion of the Talbot East building. It will be led by a director who will be selected with help from a search committee later this spring, at the conclusion of a nationwide search process that began earlier this year, Arnold said.

With so many forces that are not healthy pressing upon Christian colleges and universities today, Biola leaders see the center as a powerful counterweight.

“We would be so bold as to pray and plan that through this project Biola would be a place where God would begin a revival the likes of which we have never seen and the impact of which would be globally felt, advancing the gospel around the world,” the center’s proposal document states.

— JASON NEWELL



## **CENTER *for the* STUDY of the WORK and MINISTRY of the HOLY SPIRIT TODAY**

### **WHAT THE CENTER WILL DO**

When it begins operating in the fall of 2017, the Center for the Study of the Work and Ministry of the Holy Spirit Today will lead a range of activities and initiatives, including:

#### **GLOBAL LEADER-IN-RESIDENCE**

Each year, the center will fund two one-week intensive residencies for an internationally influential Christian leader who can educate the Biola community about the Holy Spirit’s current work around the world. This leader will seek to inspire a passion for Holy Spirit-infused ministry on a global scale and the role every Christian plays in the Great Commission.

#### **FACULTY FELLOWS RESEARCH PROGRAM**

Each semester, the center will fund a two-course release for two professors to work collaboratively on a research project of interest that supports and fulfills the center’s purpose.

#### **BIENNIAL INTERNATIONAL STUDENT CONFERENCE ON SPIRIT EMPOWERMENT**

One of the center’s most far-reaching projects is the launch of an international conference at Biola, which will draw students from around the world to help them be transformed by discovering a new openness to the reality of the Holy Spirit and his transforming power, with the goal of advancing the gospel.

#### **BIENNIAL SYMPOSIUM**

The center will sponsor a biennial symposium open to the Biola University community and the public at large, featuring papers published by the faculty engaged in research.

#### **SPIRIT EMPOWERMENT VESPERS**

Each month, the center will host evening services for prayer and focus on Holy Spirit empowerment. These evening “vespers” will have as a focus Spirit-led renewal on campus and will bring in guest speakers who will teach and lead our students toward a movement of Spirit renewal, calling students to greater boldness and witness in their lives.

#### **COLLABORATIVE WORK WITH BIOLA DEPARTMENTS**

The center will come alongside and enhance the work of existing departments and efforts across the university.

# Biola's Campus, Like You've Never Seen it Before

Virtual reality headsets give prospective students a 360-degree tour

DO YOU EVER wish you could transport yourself to Biola's campus? Stand under the Bell Tower on a sunny day? Grab a quiet seat next to the Fluor Fountain? Look up into the iconic library beacon and read all the light-themed Scriptures?

Well, now you can — without ever leaving your living room.

Thanks to an innovative new virtual reality tour, anyone anywhere can now get an immersive experience of Biola's campus using nothing more than a smartphone and an inexpensive virtual reality headset.

Developed by YouVisit, the tour takes people on a guided journey through campus, with stops at key buildings and landmarks. At 31 different spots along the way, viewers can use their headsets to get a completely panoramic view of their surroundings, including such locations as the Waugh Prayer Chapel, Chase Gymnasium, Talbot East's rooftop garden or the lobby of Biola's newest residence hall, Blackstone Hall.

"The VR headset can give you the sensation that you're actually standing in these different locations on Biola's campus," said Brian Miller, senior director in Biola's university communications and marketing office, who helped to lead the tour project. "From Metzger Lawn, for example, you can look all around you at the library or Calvary Chapel, or up into the blue sky, or even down at the flowers at your feet. It's really quite impressive."

The tour was implemented primarily as a tool for reaching prospective students who

may not be able to travel to campus (though it's a fun option for nostalgic alumni, too). Earlier this year, Biola mailed out cardboard virtual reality goggles to more than 3,000 prospective students who had expressed interest in the university. In addition to providing access to the tour, the customized red headsets will also be compatible with additional 360-degree video experiences that Biola plans to debut over the coming year.

To experience the tour yourself using a virtual reality headset (such as Google Cardboard), simply download the YouVisit VR app on your phone, and then visit **biola.edu/vr**. To experience a more basic version of the tour without a headset, visit **youvisit.com/biola**.

— JASON NEWELL

[YOUVISIT.COM/BIOLA](http://YOUVISIT.COM/BIOLA)

EXPERIENCE THE TOUR FOR YOURSELF!  
FOR THE BEST EXPERIENCE, USE A  
VIRTUAL REALITY HEADSET SUCH AS  
GOOGLE CARDBOARD, DOWNLOAD THE  
YOUVISIT VR APP ON YOUR PHONE AND  
VISIT [BIOLA.EDU/VR](http://BIOLA.EDU/VR).



# Green Acres

Biola's athletic teams had double cause to celebrate last fall: Not only did the university kick off the school year by announcing its transition to the NCAA Division II, but it also opened the season by unveiling significant renovations to Al Barbour Field. The new synthetic turf (including a bright red "BU" logo) and restriped track — made necessary due to surfaces that had deteriorated since the facility opened in 2005 — have created better playing conditions as teams prepare to compete in a new national conference.

Photo by David Baxter







# Called to Reach Every Nation

Christian Gessner's entrepreneurial spirit leads him from Brazil to Biola



AS THE FOUNDER OF AIRBNB IN LATIN AMERICA, Christian Gessner spent years helping millions of wanderlusts find homes while traveling. Now, the globally minded entrepreneur has found a new home of his own — Biola's Talbot School of Theology, where he's seeking a biblical foundation for a new gospel-focused online venture.

Gessner, born and raised in Germany, with a German father and a mother who was born in South Korea, is a self-described global citizen. In 2006, he went on an adventure with two friends and traveled to 12 countries within the span of two months, spending 10 days in Brazil. After that trip, he knew he had to go back to Brazil to consider living and working there. To keep the experience fresh in his mind, he put up a photo of *Cristo Redentor*, the Christ the Redeemer monument that overlooks Rio de Janeiro. He even started learning Portuguese. He eventually worked and lived in Brazil for nearly a decade and became the founder and country manager for Airbnb in Latin America.

With a background in business and a doctorate in innovation management, Gessner has always felt a strong calling to be an entrepreneur. While at Airbnb between 2011 and 2015, he sensed the Lord planting a seed in his heart to begin a new venture: faceGodnow, a global platform to reach non-believers.

He hopes to create an online platform that focuses specifically on reaching a population who have yet to hear the gospel, to plant seeds and lead individuals in discovering and growing their faith.

"The church completely under-leverages the internet and what it could be," said Gessner, now at Talbot pursuing a master's in biblical and theological studies. He, along with his wife and son, are experiencing the joys of being part of Biola's community. Gessner said he chose to study at Biola because it was a great fit for both him and his family, and because he knew this place would help him grow in his spiritual maturity.

"I always say it feels like a revolution for me because I am in awe and amazed by what Biola offers in terms of spiritual formation," he said.

- JOANNA WU

## FIVE FAVES

### FAVORITE BOOK

FIRST, THE BIBLE; SECOND, *THE 7 HABITS OF HIGHLY EFFECTIVE PEOPLE*

### FAVORITE BIBLE PASSAGE

PSALM 1

### FAVORITE CHRISTIAN THINKER

KYLE STROBEL

### FAVORITE PLACE HE'S VISITED

THE EUROPEAN MEDITERRANEAN COAST

### FAVORITE SPORT

SOCCER

IN THEIR WORDS

SCIENCE ACTUALLY

**STRENGTHENS**

MY FAITH.... THERE'S AN

**EXCITEMENT** THAT

COMES BY BEING A **SCIENTIST**

**WITH FAITH**, ONE

YOU WOULD NEVER KNOW IF YOU DIDN'T

**HAVE FAITH.**



**JAMES TOUR**, a synthetic organic chemist and professor at Rice University, giving a lecture at Biola on Sept. 29, 2016: "Does Science Make Faith Obsolete?"

*God took* THE WORST THING IN

HISTORY – *the cross* – AND TURNED

IT INTO THE *best thing in*

*history*. IF HE CAN DO THAT WITH *the*

*cross*, HOW MUCH MORE CAN HE DO THAT

*with you?*

**NABEEL QURESHI (M.A. '08)**, delivering his fall 2016 commencement address, "Fulfill Your Ministry," on Dec. 16, 2016.

THE BIBLE IS STRONGLY **UNIQUE**. ... THE BIBLE

WILL BE **DEMANDING** TO OUR INTELLECT AND

CATEGORIES, **OFFENSIVE** TO US AND A STONE

FOR STUMBLING, JUST BECAUSE **IT DOES NOT**

**FIT**. IT IS NOT A MEMBER OF **A CLASS**, NOT **AN**

**INSTANCE**, HOWEVER EXALTED, OF A LARGER KIND.

... NO, **THE HOLY SCRIPTURES** OF THE

OLD AND NEW TESTAMENT **ARE BEYOND ALL**

**FAMILIAR** LANDSCAPES, GENRES AND KINDS.

**KATHERINE SONDEREGGER**, theologian at Virginia Theological Seminary, delivering a plenary address, "A Lamp Unto our Feet," at the 5th annual Los Angeles Theology Conference on Biola's campus on Jan. 13, 2017.

# Strides in Speech

Biola's Speech-Language Clinic trains students while serving the local community

JUST A FEW YEARS AGO, WHITTIER RESIDENT LUIS CONTRERAS noticed his elementary-aged son becoming more and more self-conscious about his speech. His son had a common speech problem among kids: articulation of the "r" sound. He'd become increasingly quiet and participated less in class because peers would make fun of how he talked.

Since his son attended a private school, speech therapy services were not readily available as they are in public school systems, and private sessions were very expensive. Contreras tried using online tools but didn't find them highly effective.

That's when Contreras discovered Biola University's Speech-Language Clinic, a resource that provides affordable services to the local community and training opportunities for undergraduate and graduate students. After four semesters of weekly sessions at the clinic, his son's speech and confidence were thriving.

"It was life-changing for him — a complete blessing," Contreras said. Now, Contreras is excited to know his daughter can also enroll in the program when the clinic begins offering services at his daughter's private elementary school in Whittier.

Biola's Speech-Language Clinic is an on-campus service with a two-fold purpose: to provide students with clinical work experience, and to provide in-demand services for the surrounding community. The clinic offers undergraduate and graduate students from Biola's communication sciences and disorders department opportunities to provide assessments and intervention to patients with a variety of communication disorders in a controlled, well-supervised environment. Some of the disorders include stuttering, autism, language disorders and language loss due to traumatic brain injury and stroke. Their clients include children and adults ranging from 2 to 82 years of age.

"We have a very good reputation with the community," said Yvana Uranga-Hernandez, the clinic's director. "God's given us the privilege to serve in this way, and I think it's great for our clients as well as for our students because many undergrad students don't have the opportunity to do that."

For the clinical practicum, undergraduates are required to complete two credits, which equates to two clients a semester, or close to 24 hours of client contact. The clinic is a distinctive program that allows Biola's students to have hands-on clinical experience before they graduate or apply for graduate programs.

Uranga-Hernandez has served as the clinic director for more than 10 years, while the clinic has been around for more than 30 years. Despite its well-established history, some are still learning about it for the first time.

Biola alumna Caryn Silzer ('02) didn't know about the clinic until the fall of 2015 when her daughter was invited to participate in a diagnostic clinic. In that evaluation, Silzer learned that her daughter had an articulation disorder. Silzer said she and her husband had never noticed any speech issues since they had no trouble understanding their daughter's speech; with this discovery, they decided to have



their son evaluated as well, and found he had a lateral lisp. Now, after a year in the program, Silzer said, "They've made significant strides." She's seen how both her kids are much more confident and comfortable speaking up and also more intelligible.

In addition to a Bachelor of Science in Communication Sciences and Disorders, the Department of Communication Sciences and Disorders recently launched a Master of Science in Speech-Language Pathology in the fall of 2016.

— JOANNA WU

MAGAZINE.BIOLA.EDU



VIEW THE ARTICLE ONLINE FOR MORE INFORMATION ON THE SPEECH-LANGUAGE CLINIC AND LINKS TO INFORMATION ABOUT GRADUATE AND UNDERGRADUATE PROGRAMS.

# William Lane Craig Named in Biola's First Endowed Chair

AN ENDOWED CHAIR HAS BEEN ESTABLISHED in recognition of William Lane Craig, a world-renowned philosopher and theologian who has been teaching at Biola's Talbot School of Theology for more than 20 years. Funded through a generous donation, the William Lane Craig Endowed Chair in Philosophy will permanently create a faculty position at Talbot in honor of Craig's ongoing legacy. It is the first endowed chair established at Biola.

Lawrence "Wayne" Swindel and his wife, Sandra "Ronnie," have generously offered a planned gift of \$3 million for the endowed position, which met more than half of Biola's campaign goal for endowed chairs and lectureships. This gift will support Biola's ambition to become a global center for Christian thought and continue its mission to cultivate and disseminate influential scholarship that will speak to critical world issues from a solidly biblical perspective.

Craig, research professor of philosophy at Talbot, is popularly known for his many public debates, including one with the late popular atheist Christopher Hitchens; his many books, including *Reasonable Faith: Christian Truth and Apologetics*; and his wide-reaching online ministry at Reasonable Faith ([reasonablefaith.org](http://reasonablefaith.org)).

The Swindels are personal friends and long-time supporters of Craig and his wife, Jan, and have sat under Craig's teaching in the Defenders class at their home church in Georgia. Wayne Swindel hopes the establishment of this chair will carry Craig's legacy into the future and



provide greater opportunities for academics following in Craig's path.

"Bill has done some outstanding work, particularly in the last half century — and continues to do so now — through his ministry at Reasonable Faith," Swindel said. "I'd like to maintain remembrance of those things going forward for his work in philosophy and church doctrine."

With this generous gift, this endowed chair will ensure a permanent faculty position, providing greater access to new scholarly opportunities for both faculty and students. Biola will continue its efforts to influence the world of ideas by developing funds for endowed chairs and lectureships.

"Hopefully, going forward, the chair will become fully established and provide incentive and motivation for others to follow a similar route and make contributions that would establish chairs in other people's names," Swindel said.

To support the William Lane Craig Endowed Chair in Philosophy, visit [connect.biola.edu/williamlanecraig](http://connect.biola.edu/williamlanecraig).

— JOANNA WU

## Biola Launches New Online Programs

AN INCREASING NUMBER OF STUDENTS, particularly adult learners, are pursuing academic degrees online. To help meet the growing demand, Biola University is significantly expanding its lineup of online programs this fall to include fully online master's programs from Talbot School of Theology and new programs for adult learners seeking to complete their bachelor's degree.

Starting this fall, Talbot will offer some of its most popular degree programs in a fully online format, including master's programs in Bible exposition, New Testament and theology. Because these programs will now be available online, Talbot anticipates a greater number of students locally, nationally and from around the world.

"We're excited to offer some of Talbot's programs online so that students who may be farther away or can't be on campus for whatever reason can now receive the same quality of learning experience as our students in the classroom," said Clinton E. Arnold, dean of Talbot School of Theology. "They will be equipped with the tools and training to understand and interpret the Scriptures and to teach others in their ministries and areas of influence."

At the undergraduate level, Biola has been offering an online bachelor's degree completion program in applied psychology for

the past two years. In the fall, it will add two more programs that are of great interest to prospective adult learners: a Bachelor of Science in Biblical Ministries, aimed at adult learners who are active in Christian ministry and desire further training in biblical interpretation, theological understanding and practical ministry; and a Bachelor of Science in Business Management, designed for adult learners who want to gain the knowledge and experience needed to become an effective leaders in the workplace.

In addition to the new programs, Biola has several existing online and hybrid programs, including master's programs in education, teaching, TESOL and intercultural studies, and various education credentials and certificates.

### BIOLA.EDU/ONLINE



LEARN MORE ABOUT THE BENEFITS OF ONLINE EDUCATION AT BIOLA AND SEE A COMPLETE LIST OF ONLINE DEGREES, CERTIFICATES AND CREDENTIALS.



## Fall Sports Roundup

### EAGLES FINISH STRONG IN FINAL YEAR OF GSAC COMPETITION

BIOLA'S ATHLETICS TEAMS enjoyed a strong fall season in their final year of membership in the NAIA and the Golden State Athletic Conference, finishing strong enough to close out the calendar year ranked fourth in the nation in the Learfield Directors' Cup standings. Several of the fall sports teams — soccer, cross country and volleyball — spent a significant amount of time ranked inside of their NAIA Top-25 Coaches' Polls on their way to postseason competition. The strong season gives the teams momentum heading into next year, when the Eagles will compete in the PacWest Conference and begin their transition into the NCAA Division II.

#### WOMEN'S SOCCER



In one of the strongest seasons in the history of women's soccer, this year's team set the program record for least amount of goals allowed in a season, the most shutouts and the most wins at home. The team finished undefeated in the regular season (14-0-2), before losing in the first round of the NAIA tournament in November, ending their season with a 15-2-2 record overall.

Seniors Jessie Burns, McKenna Marmelstein, Taylor Venegas, Kayla White and Mariyah Ziermer ended their college careers as the most decorated players the program has seen

to date, and are distinguished as the only graduating class to reach the NAIA National Tournament in their final two seasons. Burns further holds the rank of CoSIDA Academic All-American, while sophomore Madysen Brown earned NAIA All-American status for the second time this year, and junior Cat Newberry earned her first All-American honorable mention.

#### MEN'S SOCCER

After a well-fought season, men's soccer lost in a heartbreaking match against Vanguard University in the first round of the GSAC tournament in November. After a tied-up game, the Eagles lost in the shootout against the Lions, ending their season with a 10-6-1 record. This season was the last for Leonardo Contreras, who earned NAIA All-American status for the second time. The season also brought a CoSIDA Academic All-American honor for junior Keaton Kerr.



#### CROSS COUNTRY

The women's cross country team continued to dominate the GSAC this season — running to their second-straight team championship (and fifth overall), an individual title for Lyndee Dawson and six All-GSAC honors. The

Eagles went on to finish in third place in the NAIA cross country championship for the second year in a row, with sophomore Emily Ransom and Dawson earning All-American honors. The men's cross country team also enjoyed success in the GSAC Championship meet, with three All-GSAC honors and a third place overall finish.

#### VOLLEYBALL

The women's volleyball team made it to the NAIA National Championship tournament for the 16th time in program history in December, eventually losing to the No. 3 seed, but finishing their season with a 26-11 record. The Eagles finished in second place in the GSAC conference this season with a 13-3 conference record, and standout junior captain Tess Van Grouw was awarded her first NAIA All-American honorable mention. Van Grouw also set a new team record for digs in a season.



[BIOLA.EDU/DIVISION2](http://BIOLA.EDU/DIVISION2)



LEARN MORE ABOUT BIOLA'S TRANSITION  
TO NCAA DIVISION II.



# think biblically

## Insight & Research from Faculty & Alumni

- Professor Kitty Purgason receives her third Fulbright grant
- Sociology professor's research examines bias in Hollywood
- Does God really help those who help themselves?

## ASK AN EXPERT

# How Should Christians Think About Power?

The 2016 U.S. election sparked new discussions about the political power and influence of American Christians. Should Christians seek power in government and other worldly spheres of influence? Or are the temptations of earthly power antithetical to the “power in weakness” approach we see in the New Testament? Has the church abandoned Jesus’ view of power?

In their new book, *The Way of the Dragon or the Way of the Lamb*, pastor Jamin Goggin (’03, M.A. ’08) and Kyle Strobel (M.A. ’02, M.A. ’05), assistant professor of spiritual theology and formation at Talbot School of Theology, explore some of these questions. Featuring interviews and insights from Christian leaders like J.I. Packer, Marva Dawn, John Perkins, Eugene Peterson and Dallas Willard, the book challenges believers to adopt a more Christ-like understanding of where power comes from and what it is for.

*Biola Magazine* recently sat down with Goggin and Strobel to discuss the book and how Jesus redefines power, success and privilege.

**In America we have this value of the self-made success story, a rags-to-riches mythology where you can come from nothing and “make something of yourself.” Is there anything good we can glean from this as Christians? Or is this just a story of worldly power?**

**STROBEL:** I think the good in it is usually when the telos has a virtue tied to it. For example, it may not be “I want to be greedy”

as much as “I want to make a lot of money so that I can give, so that I can bless.” Usually there is a “so that,” which is virtuous. The problem is the entire structure of this is so wedded to a fleshiness and a worldliness and a view of success that is tied to power from below. That will almost always warp it. The biblical image that strikes me is that we try to sow in the flesh and reap in the spirit. And that’s always folly. I think this kind of “self made” power is just fleshly autonomy. We’ve allowed ourselves to ignore sinful autonomy for the sake of a greater good.

**GOGGIN:** In the kingdom of God, the ends do not justify the means. But it’s a temptation. In the church, it can be language like this: “Well, more people are coming to Christ; more people are being baptized. Whatever we need to do to keep this going, so be it.” But as Dallas [Willard] has said, we’re not just called to do “Jesus things,” but to do them Jesus’ way. Surely the means matter in the kingdom. In kingdom terms, a curving inward to the self in order to “get things done” is antithetical to the way of Jesus. Jesus says it very clearly: “Apart from me you can do nothing.”

**How should Christians think about our strengths in a healthy way, and how should we think about our weaknesses?**

**GOGGIN:** For us, the axiom of embracing power in weakness is incredibly important. It means I don’t reject the fact that I have certain gifts or talents or abili-





ties. I don't seek to eschew those. But how I hold them and steward them is grounded in a deeper reality that they have been given to me by God, and that I am fundamentally frail and finite and fragile. On top of that, left to my own devices, these things are actually of no benefit to the kingdom and can actually be harmful to people. But if embraced in an abiding relationship with God and a fundamental posture of dependence and trust and need, now I can move forward in stewarding these things in a faithful way, for kingdom purposes.

**You explore Henri Nouwen's idea of "downward mobility" in the book. How would you advise a new Biola graduate when it comes to living out downward mobility? How does that fit with "impacting the world for Christ"?**

**GOGGIN:** So much of the narrative is, "What does it mean to have big faith? To do big things for the kingdom?" And there's something in that which is really good. And yet, in a generation that is perhaps more prone to grandiosity and a "you can do anything" mindset, I think actually the greatest faith is often found in whether we actually believe and trust that courageously faithful and heroic acts that no one will ever see or know about really do matter, and that God is at work in this. ... Often for the heart that is prone to grandiosity, the greatest act of faith is, "Are you willing to be faithful in the little things and embrace a life of hiddenness?"

**STROBEL:** There may be two or three people globally from our generation who will be remembered, history tells us. It's probably not going to be any of us. If it is, praise God. If it isn't, praise God. That has to be our approach. Lord, whatever you have for me, praise God. We haven't heard that very much. We've heard "It could be you!" No it won't, but praise God anyway. In fact, in the kingdom it is the hidden things that will be more honored. But we still don't think that.

**The hiddenness question is a huge one in our age of "platform." Some people argue that a huge platform is good for the sake of mission, that it's not about pride as much as pragmatic tool to reach the most people. Is a big audience or platform inherently a bad thing?**

**GOGGIN:** It's really an issue of the heart. We want to avoid the simple formula of "Don't do social media. Don't write books. Always say no to offers to speak to big crowds." The question we want to go back to is, "Where do you believe power comes from and what is it for?" The truth is, I have been in very small churches and taught in youth groups of 30 students, and grandiosity is still a temptation of the heart. Leading in ministry for the sake of recognition or power or being viewed in a certain way can still be just as palpable as if it were a room of 5,000.

**Some younger Christians have a sort of shame about the church. They see power in relevance, and they don't think the church is relevant. This gives rise to the temptation to make church cool. What would you say to younger Christians who may be ashamed of the hidden, unexciting, seemingly "irrelevant" aspects of church?**

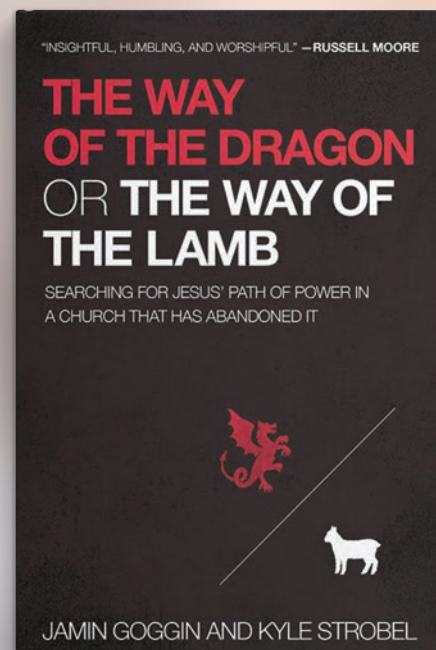
**STROBEL:** We have to recover the mundane. This is why I think this generation is so removed from the church. The church doesn't feel like it works. In our worldly power system the church is really stupid. It just does not make sense. So we're seeing the result of this. If the church doesn't make sense, let's change the church, because they're trying to interpret it in worldly frameworks.

I think of Paul's expression in Galatians of "do not grow weary of doing good" (6:9), and the idea of "you will bear fruit in its season." The problem with the desire for relevance is that it's a desire to not have to be patient. There's an immediacy to it. We don't come up with a definition of power and relevance and then apply it to the church. Theologically that's false. We recognize that in the king-

dom, *this* is power and the acts of the church lay shame to the powers and principalities. If my view of power can't make sense of coming to the Lord's table and being weak, as an act to stand against evil, the problem is with my understanding of power and relevance and importance and success.

**What can churches do to ensure a healthy rather than toxic leadership culture?**

**STROBEL:** One of the biblical commands that we often just ignore outright is also the only biblical command that encourages competition: that you should "outdo one another in showing honor" (Rom. 12:10). We're much more interested in outdoing one another in *receiving honor*. We're very uninterested in outdoing one another in *showing honor*. I think that means if we're looking for an elder or pastor, we look for the kind of person who outdoes other people in *showing honor*, not receiving honor. Right now we have a lot of people who clamor for power, and so we call them leaders. But in the kingdom these are people we should worry about.



## THE EXPERTS

**Jamin Goggin** ('03, M.A. '08) has been in pastoral ministry for 11 years, and currently serves as a pastor at Mission Hills Church in San Marcos, Calif. He holds two master's degrees and is currently earning a Ph.D. in systematic theology. **Kyle Strobel** (M.A. '02, M.A. '05) is a professor of spiritual theology and formation at Biola's Talbot School of Theology. He holds a Ph.D. from the University of Aberdeen and has published numerous popular and academic books and articles.



## □ FACULTY RESEARCH FOCUS

# A Traveling Teacher of Teachers

Professor Kitty Purgason receives her third Fulbright grant

From the beginning of her life, Kitty Purgason seemed to have been groomed for international relations.

Growing up in India as the daughter of a missionary, Purgason developed an early interest in travel and other languages — an interest that ultimately led her into a flourishing career in the field of TESOL (Teaching English as a Second Language) and applied linguistics.

Throughout the course of her life, Purgason has visited 14 different countries, four of which she has taught in, and seven of which she has visited to conduct teacher training conferences. Two of the countries she has visited, Turkey and Turkmenistan, have been as a Fulbright fellow, and this spring, Purgason is partnering with the program once again.

In July 2016, Purgason received her third Fulbright U.S. Scholar Program grant, and in the spring of 2017, she is training English language teachers in Dushanbe, Tajikistan,

at the Dushanbe branch of Lomonosov Moscow State University.

The Fulbright Program, a flagship international exchange program sponsored by the U.S. government, is designed to increase mutual understanding and support friendly and peaceful relations between U.S. citizens and citizens of other countries. The program provides participants chosen for their academic merit and leadership potential with the opportunity to teach, study and conduct research, allowing them to exchange ideas and contribute to shared international concerns. Of the 8,000 grants awarded annually, only 1,200 of these are scholars.

According to Purgason, Fulbright had been looking for someone to train teachers at the undergraduate or graduate level via in-service workshops or seminars, and to develop programs to build teacher capacity for research.

“Those are all activities which I do at Biola University and have done overseas,”

said Purgason, who has taught at Biola since 1991. “My instruction emphasizes practical methodology, which allows even busy, under-resourced people to teach well and meet a variety of student needs.”

During her time in Tajikistan, Purgason is conducting several in-service courses for faculty on TESOL methodology and teaching academic writing. In conjunction with the latter, she taught writing to university students, providing a model class for the faculty.

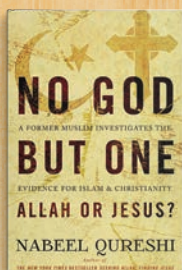
For Purgason, working overseas is important to her not only as someone interested in developing educational capacity all over the world, but specifically as a professor of TESOL at Biola University.

“In our TESOL programs I am training teachers who are working internationally or in U.S. classrooms with people from around the world,” said Purgason. “I want to have fresh examples to give my students so they are prepared in the best way possible.”

— KATHRYN TOOMBS

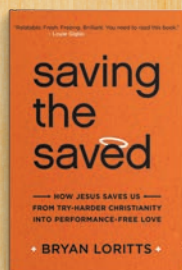
# Books by Biolans

Noteworthy new publications from Biola faculty and alumni



**No God But One: Allah or Jesus? A Former Muslim Investigates the Evidence for Islam and Christianity**, by Nabeel Qureshi (M.A. '08), Zondervan, August 2016. In *No God but One*, *New York Times* best-selling author Nabeel

Qureshi takes readers on a global, historical, yet deeply personal journey to the heart of the world's two largest religions. He explores the claims that each faith makes upon believers' intellects and lives, critically examining the evidence in support of their distinctive beliefs. Fleshed out with stories from the annals of both religions, *No God But One* unveils the fundamental, enduring conflict between Islam and Christianity — directly addressing controversial topics like Jihad, the Crusades, Sharia, the Trinity and more.



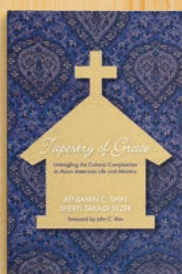
**Saving the Saved: How Jesus Saves Us from Try-Harder Christianity into Performance-Free Love**, by Bryan Loritts (M.A. '98, Biola trustee), Zondervan, October 2016. God doesn't want your spiritual scorekeeping. He simply wants

your surrender. The punchline of the Gospel of Matthew is just that — a message of grace and performance-free love to do-good, try-harder Jews who thought they had to earn their way into God's favor. It's an ancient message, yet it can be a lifeline to us today as we live in a world of performance metrics. *Saving the Saved* proclaims the good news that once the pressure is off to perform, we are free to abide. Beyond the man-made rules and the red tape, there is a God who knows you by name. Come and meet him as you've never known him before.



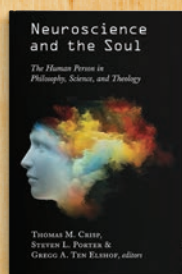
**The Triune God**, by Fred Sanders (professor of theology, Torrey Honors Institute), Zondervan, December 2016. *The Triune God* aims to secure our knowledge of the triune God by rightly ordering the theological language with which we

praise him. It reaches its conclusions about how the doctrine should be handled on the basis of the way the Trinity was revealed. As such, it is a study that offers dogmatic principles for trinitarian exegesis. The book is the second volume in Zondervan's New Studies in Dogmatics series, which seeks to provide thoughtful, concise and readable treatments of major theological topics, expressing the biblical, creedal and confessional shape of Christian doctrine for a contemporary evangelical audience.



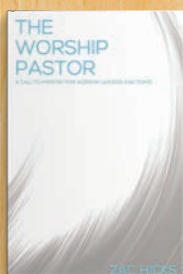
**Tapestry of Grace: Untangling the Cultural Complexities in Asian American Life and Ministry**, by Benjamin C. Shin (M.Div. '93, Th.M. '96, associate professor of Bible exposition) and Sheryl Takagi Silzer ('93), Wipf and

Stock, September 2016. Cultural and generational differences have led to many misunderstandings and conflicts within the Asian American church. How can these tangled threads be rewoven into a beautiful tapestry of God's grace? Shin and Silzer apply their years of study and teaching to explain how the cultural complexities that occur between the different generations of the Asian American church can be untangled. Taking lessons from their own spiritual journeys, they show how each generation can experience the amazing grace of the gospel.



**Neuroscience and the Soul: The Human Person in Philosophy, Science and Theology**, edited by Gregg A. Ten Elshof (professor of philosophy), Steven L. Porter (professor of philosophy and theology) and Thomas M. Crisp (pro-

fessor of philosophy), Eerdmans, November 2016. It is a widely held belief that human beings are both body and soul, that our immaterial soul is distinct from our material body. But that traditional idea has been seriously questioned by much recent research in the brain sciences. In *Neuroscience and the Soul* — the outgrowth of a conference sponsored by Biola's Center for Christian Thought — 14 distinguished scholars grapple with current debates about the existence and nature of the soul, bringing philosophy, theology and neuroscience together in conversation.



**The Worship Pastor: A Call to Ministry for Worship Leaders and Teams**, by Zac Hicks ('02), Zondervan, October 2016. Modern worship leaders are restless. They have inherited a model of leadership that equates leading

worship with being a rock star. But leading worship is more than a performance; it's about shaping souls and making disciples. Every worship leader is really a pastor. *The Worship Pastor* is a practical and biblical introduction to this essential pastoral role. Filled with engaging, illustrative stories, it is organized to address questions of theory and practice, striving to balance conversational accessibility with informed instruction. It is meant to be read by pastors, worship leaders, worship teams and anyone else interested in deepening their understanding and experience of worship.



**SUBMIT YOUR BOOK!** To feature your publication, send the title, description and cover image to [biolamag@biola.edu](mailto:biolamag@biola.edu). Submissions may appear either in Books by Biolans or Class Notes, depending on space availability.

# Hollywood's Diversity Problem

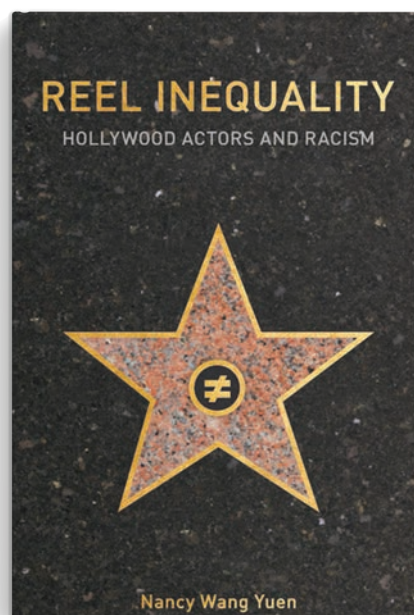
GROWING UP AS AN IMMIGRANT kid in Southern California, just miles from the Hollywood industry, I watched hours of television for amusement. This continues to be the norm today. In 2015, the average U.S. resident consumed “traditional and digital media for over 1.7 trillion hours, an average of approximately 15 and a half hours per person per day.” In the same year, children (8- to 12-year-olds) consumed an average of six hours of media a day, and teens consumed nine hours. This mind-boggling amount of media consumption shapes how we see the world we live in.

Even though my neighborhood was racially and ethnically diverse when I was growing up, the world looked completely white on television. I absorbed a very narrow vision of U.S. culture. All throughout my childhood, I did not see myself represented in film and television beyond the occasional cringe-worthy Asian nerd or massage parlor worker. In the film and television worlds, only white lives mattered, and the rest of us were either marginalized or demonized.

In college, where I learned that race is not biological but socially constructed, I also saw how Hollywood dramatized racial differences as natural and fixed. Far from neutral, mass media institutions such as Hollywood are major transmitters of racist ideologies. Antonio Gramsci theorized that society's elites use the mass media to maintain “hegemony,” or the dominance one social group holds over others. Hollywood's dominant narratives of whites as heroes and actors of color as sidekicks or villains legitimate and reproduce the racial hierarchies existent in U.S. society.

Though they are largely fictional, on-screen images can shape our views of reality. I witnessed this firsthand when I went to see *Skyfall* (2012), a James Bond film. Preview after preview of action films featured white male protagonists shooting and killing people, yet it was the preview for *Django Unchained* (2012) that elicited an extreme audience reaction. In one scene, Django (played by Jamie Foxx), a black slave-turned-bounty-hunter, says, “Kill white folks, and they pay you for it — what's not to like?” This statement caused two middle-aged white women sitting in my row to groan loudly, as one of them griped, “That's what's wrong with our urban areas!”

Even though we were about to watch a violent James Bond film and had just sat through brutal violence enacted by Tom Cruise, Bruce Willis and Arnold Schwarzenegger, none of those previews elicited critique. The lack of black heroes in film and television, coupled with the preponderance of white heroes and black villains, demonizes black male violence and legitimizes white male violence. Furthermore, this extrapolation of a fictional Django to “our urban areas” demonstrates how audiences fail to distinguish between fiction and reality in racial stereotypes. Through countless reiterations in popular media, racial stereotypes can become *real* in the minds of audiences.



Adapted from **Reel Inequality: Hollywood Actors and Racism**. New Brunswick: Rutgers University Press, 2016. Copyright 2016 by Nancy Wang Yuen (associate professor of sociology). Reprinted by permission of Rutgers University Press.

A brief interview with Kenneth C. Way (associate professor of Bible exposition), author of *Judges and Ruth: Teach the Text Commentary Series*, Baker Books, September 2016.

**Q: What sets your new commentary apart from other commentaries on Judges and Ruth?**

A: This commentary aims at giving pastors and Bible study leaders the most important information that they need to know for teaching the text. For every passage, there is one big idea — in a concise sentence — and a variety of themes and background issues that are identified. These are unpacked with a view toward teaching and illustrating the biblical text. Methodological and pedagogical advice is offered to explain both the possible pitfalls and the promising applications of every passage. There is no other commentary series on the market that does this.

**Q: It's probably a safe bet that most Christians hear more sermons from the feel-good book of Ruth than we do from the often-disturbing book of Judges. What lessons does Judges have for us today?**

A: We desperately need to study the book of Judges because it teaches us about the psychology of sin. The stories are arranged with billowing intensity to show the downward moral trajectory of sin's cycles. Unlike the book of Ruth, which positively portrays God's attributes in the daily lives of human characters, the book of Judges portrays the failure of human characters to uphold and embody God's attributes in every tribe and region of Israel. In particular, the stories implicitly show us how the teachings of Deuteronomy are often contradicted and ignored by God's people in ancient times as well as today.



# Does God Really Help Those Who Help Themselves?

I am always surprised and amused to hear people talk about verses they think are in the Bible that are not. I led a small group of college guys and when they would stumble on these imaginary quotations, I would challenge them to tell me where it was written. My favorite was this: “God helps those who help themselves.”

The stuff that we think is in the Bible tells us more about ourselves than it does about God. What do you get in a society which thinks that God helps those who help themselves? Perhaps you get an industrious society. But you also get an overly busy society. You get a society that is stressed out, that is driven and exhausted. More than anything, you get a world that hates to wait.

But what I find in the Bible is that there are two paths that one can follow in life — the path of self-reliance or the path of faith. Isaiah 30 says, “Blessed are all those who wait for him.” In the 7th century B.C., Judah was at the crossroads of a power struggle between Assyria and Egypt. There was a faction that wanted to make an alliance with Egypt. Into this crisis, Isaiah gave sage advice: “In returning and rest you shall be saved; in quietness and confidence shall be your strength.”

**1. The path of waiting is the path of surrender.** The word “returning” here really means to surrender. It means returning from the battlefield and laying down your arms. This is a picture of giving yourself over to

someone. What happens when you surrender? You release control. You abandon yourself to the will of someone else. That is the essence of surrender. That can be a frightening proposition for us. But the bottom line is that you’re not abandoning yourself to the enemy; you’re abandoning yourself to God and his gracious plan.

We all have a picture in our heads of what our future should contain, and we are determined to secure that for ourselves. In 2013, I gathered a small core group of close friends and ministry partners to plant a church. They were a dynamic group; I remember thinking that it was going to explode with growth. However, the going was much tougher than we thought. We were devastated after three years when we had to pull the plug and close Resonate. It was gut-wrenching.

During one of our last services, my 8-year-old son turned to me during the worship time and said, “Daddy, I want to put the \$100 bill that grandpa gave me into the offering box.” I asked why, and he said, “Because I don’t want our church to go away.” We fight to hold onto our vision of the future, but God says to us instead, “Surrender.”

Rest is the result of surrender. You may not know this, but there is a comfort in that place in the hollow of God’s hand. There is a quiet calmness and confidence in the midst of the storm. The result is not weakness, but inexplicable strength.

**2. The purpose of waiting is to teach you what God is like.** As it turns out, the Israelites didn’t listen to Isaiah, and so they paid a high price. But even having taken the wrong path, God didn’t abandon them. Here is what the prophet tells them on behalf of God: “Therefore the Lord waits to be gracious to you, and therefore he exalts himself to show mercy to you. For the Lord is a God of justice; blessed are all those who wait for him.”

We are given a divine perspective into who God is and how he works. In this passage, God postpones deliverance. He withholds rescue so that adversity can teach them and can bring them to dependence. Why would God allow that kind of suffering? He wants to reorient my hope. He wants to change the path that I’m on. If you have yet to come to the end of yourself, then rescue is simply interference in your plans. But God cares more about my growth than my personal comfort, and as much as I struggle with that truth, I have to admit that it reveals his grace. Waiting is the place where we discover God’s mercy and grace.

I don’t really know if God helps those who help themselves, but I do know that there are two paths before you in life: the path of self-reliance and the path of faith. Which one will you choose? Blessed is the one who waits for him.

**Daniel Radmacher** (’90, M.Div. ’04) is a pastor, author, church planter and an erstwhile musician. He lives in Pasadena, Calif., with his wife, Brenda, and his children, Drake and Ivy. You can follow him on Facebook or Twitter, or at his website, [danradmacher.com](http://danradmacher.com).



# Highlights of video resources available for free at [OPEN.BIOLA.edu](https://open.biola.edu)

## NEW

### *Fulfill Your Ministry*

Apologist and *New York Times* best-selling author Nabeel Qureshi delivers Biola's fall 2016 commencement address. Qureshi, who has a master's degree in Christian apologetics from Biola, speaks out of 2 Timothy 4 and delivers a stirring call for Biola graduates to fulfill their ministry and bring life into the world.

## POPULAR

### *Why Read?*

This lecture from March 3, 2016, is from professor Eva Brann of St. John's College (Annapolis), as part of the Distinguished Lecture Series at the Torrey Honors Institute. Brann discusses the value of reading and the importance of "great books."

## EDITOR'S PICK

### *Miracles*

In a two-part chapel series for the Talbot School of Theology, New Testament scholar Craig Keener of Asbury Theological Seminary speaks on the plausibility and historicity of miracle accounts in the Gospels.

## Highlights of resources and events from Biola's academic centers



**Center for Christian Thought**  
[cct.biola.edu](https://cct.biola.edu)

The 6th Annual CCT Conference will take place on May 5-6, 2017. The academic conference will feature a variety of papers exploring topics related to the center's 2016-17 research theme, "Humility: Moral, Religious, Intellectual."



**Center for Christianity, Culture & the Arts**  
[cca.biola.edu](https://cca.biola.edu)

Join the CCCA during Lent for daily online devotionals written by members of the Biola community and featuring songs, poems and visual art. Visit [cca.biola.edu/lent](https://cca.biola.edu/lent) through April 23.



**Center for Marriage & Relationships**  
[cmr.biola.edu](https://cmr.biola.edu)

In "The Art of Relationships" podcast, Chris Grace and Tim Muehlhoff weigh in on how to navigate the complexities of relationships in our culture with biblical wisdom and scholarly research.



**STAY UP TO DATE!** Want to learn about all the latest resources — including chapel addresses, lectures, video discussions and more — as they are released? Follow @biolau on Twitter or subscribe to Biola's YouTube channel!

# AN

*Empowered by a historic campaign that raised \$214 million, Biola University is poised to begin a bold new chapter*

*By Barry H. Corey*

*Illustrations by Rebecca DiMarzio*



# ew Day

On a January day a little more than five years ago, the Biola Board of Trustees cast a vote that made me feel both exhilarated and daunted. By formally approving the launch of a five-year, \$180 million fundraising campaign, the board was setting Biola on a course to bold new heights — but also tasking us with raising an amount nine times larger than any of the university's previous fundraising campaigns. Yet we had faith that God would provide. He had provided for Biola for more than 100 years, after all, through recessions and the Great Depression and storms of other sorts, sustaining us financially and gradually expanding Biola's size and impact. Why would he stop providing for us now?

Five years later, as I reflect on the successful completion of *A Soul of Conviction, A Voice of Courage: The Campaign for Biola University*, I am full of gratitude. God has indeed provided, beyond what we could have asked or imagined. Not only did we meet our goal of raising \$180 million by Dec. 31, 2016, but we exceeded our goal by \$34 million. Thanks be to God.

And thanks be to you, too! The entire Biola family stepped up in this historic campaign: alumni, parents, grandparents, faculty, staff, donors, foundations, friends and friends of friends. This was a team effort! We could not have done it without you. And so to all who prayed for and donated to The Campaign for Biola University, whether you gave \$12 or \$12 million, thank you. Your support was invaluable.

One of the themes of this campaign was continuity between Biola's past, present and future. The name of the campaign reflects this. "A Soul of Conviction" is about remembering the unchanging truths that have always guided us, the truth of the gospel and the gift of God's Word. "A Voice of Courage" is about moving forward unafraid, speaking truth and living with winsome relevance in a changing world. Conviction is about not feeling the need to reinvent the wheel in our core beliefs. Courage is about the freedom to adapt and explore new

boundaries of how our 109-year-old mission might be enacted in today's world.

The past and the future came together on May 9, 2015, when we publicly launched the campaign with our Conviction and Courage Gala in downtown Los Angeles, just blocks from where Biola was founded in 1908. In a large, clear-top tent behind the Ace Hotel, we gathered beneath the red neon glow of the "Jesus Saves" sign, which originally donned the tower of Biola's first building at Sixth and Hope streets. Inside the Theater at the Ace Hotel, where we celebrated the campaign launch with a concert from Phil Wickham, Josh Garrels and The Brilliance, Psalm 119:89 is inscribed above the door: "Forever, O Lord, Thy Word is settled in heaven." These are the same words that were once engraved above the entrance to the original Biola building.

These historical connections reinforced the continuity of this campaign between our past and future. It was never about taking Biola from  $x$  to  $y$ , but from  $x$  to  $x$ -squared. It wasn't about rethinking the mission for which Lyman Stewart and T.C. Horton founded Biola in the early 20th century. It was about maximizing the effectiveness of that original mission for the 21st century.

The Biola of today is asking the same questions that Biola's founders asked a century ago: How can an educational institution in a major global city like Los Angeles best educate men and women to make an impact on the world for Christ? The answer then and now is centered around a robust education in the Bible and its integration in the broader disciplines. But the specifics of what that looks like have changed.

The Biola of today is bigger, more global, more diverse in its community and more interdisciplinary than the Biola of yesteryear. The technologies we use are different. But the mission remains the same. Biola today is sending out students as it always has: with Christ-centered conviction, courage and compassion to be the lights Jesus calls us to be (Matt. 5:14).

## *The Campaign by the Numbers*

Amount raised toward  
\$180 million goal

– **\$214** –  
MILLION

Gifts of \$1 million or more

– **49** –

Endowment growth from \$73.1  
million at the start of the campaign

– **\$132** –  
MILLION

Total number of supporters  
toward the campaign

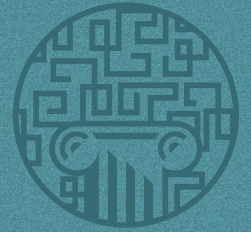
– **20,730** –

President's Circle members  
year-by-year

|      |              |
|------|--------------|
| 2012 | <b>654</b>   |
| 2013 | <b>812</b>   |
| 2014 | <b>1,012</b> |
| 2015 | <b>1,165</b> |
| 2016 | <b>1,301</b> |

# *Snapshots of Impact*

*The Campaign for Biola University successfully raised \$214 million to support four main categories. Here are just a few tangible examples of how the funding is already being used to make a difference in the lives of Biola students and further the cause of Christ around the world.*



One of the personal joys I experienced through this campaign was visiting some of these “lights” all over the world. As part of our 16-city Campaign National Tour, I was able to see how Biola graduates are making a difference in places like Washington, D.C., Phoenix, Portland, New York City, Jakarta and Seoul. Everywhere I went I was impressed to see the ways alumni were living with conviction, speaking with courage and loving with compassion. I know Stewart and Horton would have been impressed too.

At our Portland event last October, legendary evangelist Luis Palau was our speaker,

and in his remarks he called Biola “a model for all Bible colleges and universities.” At our Los Angeles event in November, alumnus David Kinnaman ('96), author and president of the Barna Group, described the unique educational experience of Biola as a “counter-culture for the common good.” At our Chicago event, pastor and radio host Christopher Brooks (M.A. '10) shared about how Biola shaped his view of urban ministry and God's heart for cities.

Across the world we are hearing words like this from alumni, investors, observers and friends: Biola University is an institution oc-

*Campaign Category:*

## IMPROVE STUDENT AFFORDABILITY

If junior biology major Martha Lopez had not received the Dr. Francis Yu Mei Li Scholarship, she probably would not be at Biola. "Scholarships are my miracle," said Lopez, a first-generation student studying to be a doctor. According to Lopez, "Biola has molded me into a person who wants to be compassionate and show mercy to all those who are around me." Lopez plans to attend medical school and then commit herself to making a difference in a rural community. She is one of hundreds of students whose dreams and future impact have been made possible through the scholarship funds raised in The Campaign for Biola.

*Campaign Category:*

## PROVIDE FACILITIES THAT INSPIRE LEARNING

Thanks to The Campaign for Biola, construction began in February 2016 on the Alton and Lydia Lim Center for Science, Technology and Health. The 91,200-square-foot building is on schedule to receive its occupancy permit in October 2017 and open for classes in January 2018. When it opens, the building will be the largest academic facility on campus and will be home to the newly launched School of Science, Technology and Health. It will be home to the departments of nursing, biological science, human biology, environmental science, chemistry, physics, engineering physics, physical science, biochemistry, math and computer science.

*Campaign Category:*

## INFLUENCE THE WORLD OF IDEAS

The Center for Christian Thought (CCT) launched in February 2012 to produce accessible Christian scholarship on questions that matter to the church and the academy. To date, the center has received over 350 grant applications, published dozens of articles, videos and other resources through its website and journal, *The Table*, and sponsored or co-sponsored numerous events such as "Free to Disagree" with Cornel West, Robert George and Rick Warren. The center's website has been viewed more than 620,000 times by more than 184,000 unique visitors, and has grown to 12,000 email subscribers and 8,000 social media followers.

*Campaign Category:*

## EXTEND BIOLA'S GLOBAL REACH

John and Marilyn Long created the Long Family Foundation to share their hearts and support research, education, religion and the arts. In 2015, the Long Family Foundation worked with Biola to establish the global online Certificate in Integrative Counseling (CIC). Early in 2017, Biola's Rosemead School of Psychology launched the CIC in Asia. All 24 students in the first cohort live and work in China and are eager to learn culturally sensitive ways to integrate their faith with their counseling practices. "This program is a creative new way that Biola is offering our educational resources to the global community," said program director Martha Chiu.

cupying a rare and important space in higher education, one that the world needs now more than ever.

## SIGNS OF MOMENTUM

*A Soul of Conviction, A Voice of Courage:* The Campaign for Biola University has been about amplifying and accelerating the forward momentum that is already underway at Biola. There are so many encouraging signs of how this is happening now, and what the future holds.

One of the major emphases of the cam-

paign has been providing facilities that inspire learning. Momentum in this area is hard to miss if you have been to campus recently. A new residence hall (Blackstone), a renovated Eagles' Nest and patio, a transformed Emerson Hall (from a residence hall to faculty offices): this is just some of what is new in the last few years.

The biggest change to the campus "skyline" is still to come, with the Alton and Lydia Lim Center for Science, Technology and Health now under construction and set to open in less than a year. The area just south of Metzger Hall is currently home to a ris-

ing four-story steel skeleton that will soon become the largest academic building on campus. We look forward to the momentum this building will represent for our newly launched School of Science, Technology and Health, under the leadership of founding dean Paul Ferguson.

The next few years will bring even more campus improvements, with a new Admissions Welcome Center for prospective students set to open, along with a dramatic facelift to the interior of Calvary Chapel from internationally known Danish artists Peter Brandes and Maja Lisa Engelhardt.

# Report from the Road

For 14 months in 2015–16, President Barry Corey and members of Biola’s Office of Advancement and Alumni Relations took the campaign “on the road” to 14 U.S. cities with high concentrations of Biolans. Nearly 1,000 alumni, parents and supporters attended these fundraising receptions and contributed nearly \$900,000 in gifts and pledges toward the campaign. This was the first time Biola had attempted a national tour of this sort, but plans are already underway for future regional gatherings!



**1**  
**NEWPORT BEACH**  
SEPT. 26, 2015  
ATTENDANCE: 92  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$63,375



**5**  
**SACRAMENTO**  
MARCH 18, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 97  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$185,250



**2**  
**RIVERSIDE**  
OCT. 9, 2015  
ATTENDANCE: 65  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$272,065



**6**  
**WASHINGTON D.C.**  
APRIL 1, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 48  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$11,350



**3**  
**SAN DIEGO**  
OCT. 15, 2015  
ATTENDANCE: 49  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$6,870



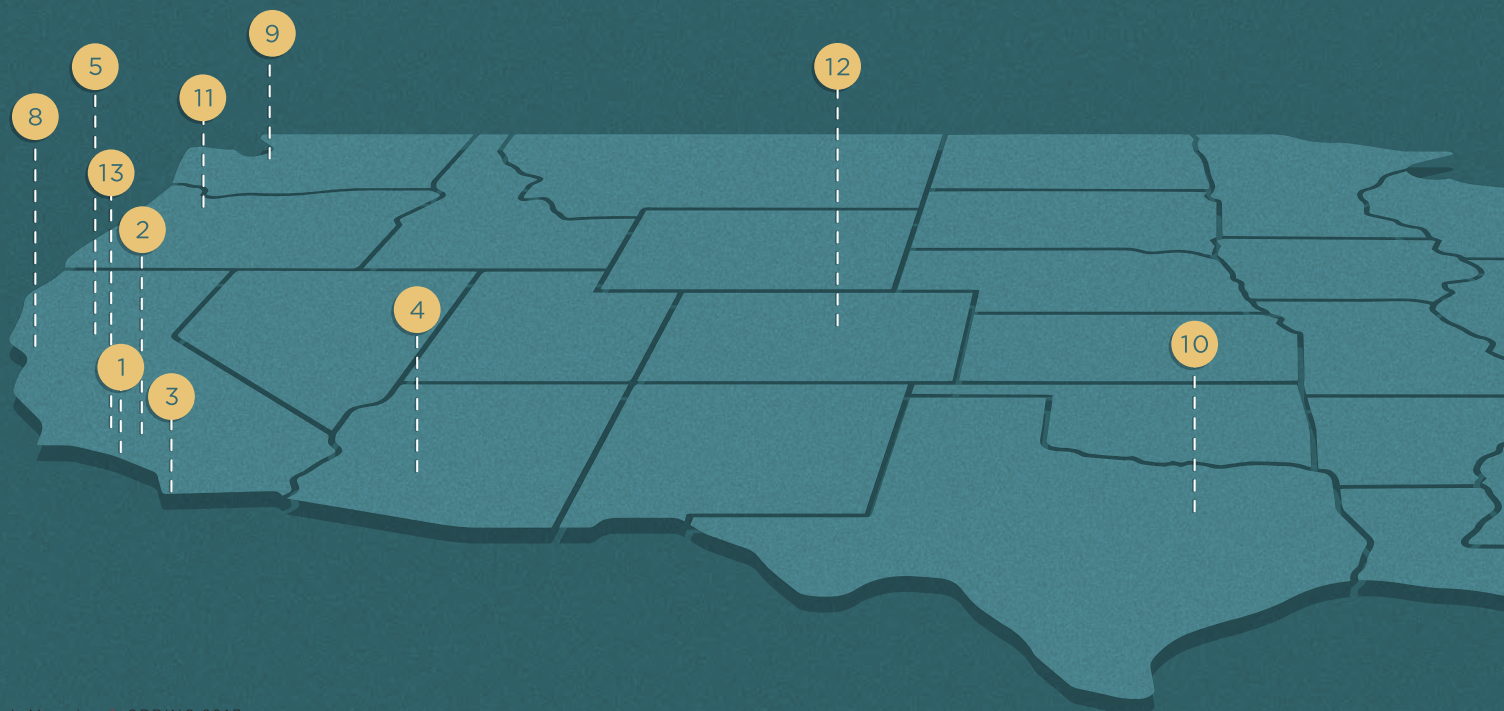
**7**  
**NEW YORK CITY**  
APRIL 2, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 51  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$7,105



**4**  
**PHOENIX**  
JAN. 15, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 63  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$20,605



**8**  
**SAN FRANCISCO**  
APRIL 16, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 55  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$48,170





**SEATTLE**  
MAY 7, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 123  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$92,395



**DALLAS**  
OCT. 1, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 50  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$21,500



**PORTLAND**  
OCT. 8, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 88  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$40,908



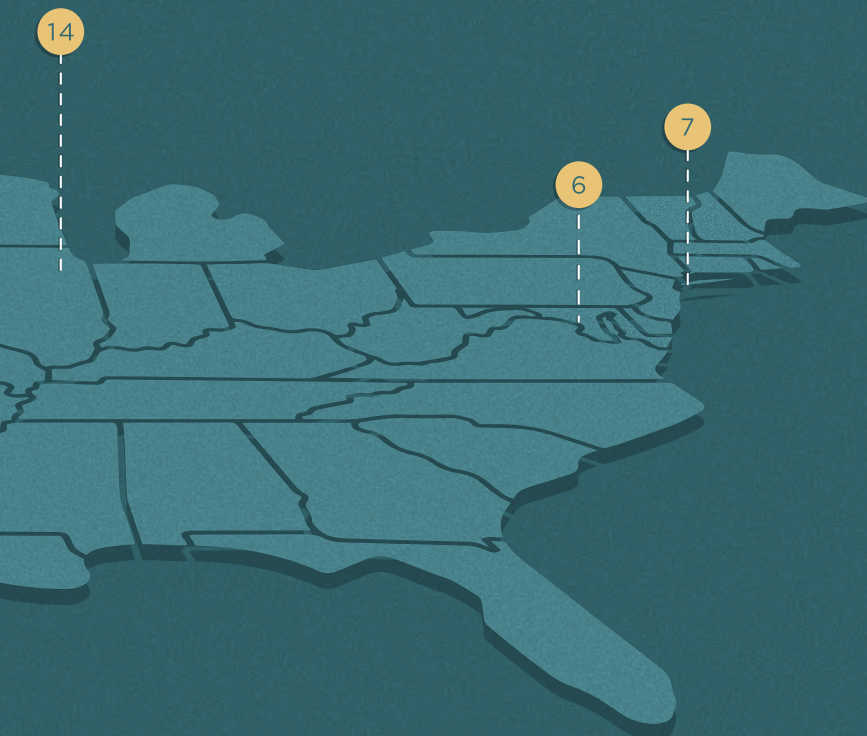
**DENVER**  
OCT. 22, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 67  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$18,725



**LOS ANGELES**  
NOV. 5, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 60  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$17,351



**CHICAGO**  
NOV. 12, 2016  
ATTENDANCE: 53  
AMOUNT RAISED: \$53,375



More than the buildings and campus improvements, however, momentum can be seen in the *people* that comprise the Biola community.

This fall we had one of the largest freshman classes in our history, and we saw 8 percent growth in students of color among freshmen. Our students are graduating faster than they were a decade ago, and our graduation and retention rates are higher than average for our category. There is great innovation coming out of our Division of Student Success, led by dean Carrie Stockton, including a FirstGen Scholars Program that supports incoming students who are in the first generation of their family to graduate with a bachelor's degree.

I believe today's staff and administration team is the strongest in Biola's history. With Deborah Taylor newly installed as provost and senior vice president, and André Stephens recently appointed vice president of student development, our leadership team is strong, diverse and united in the challenges they are together addressing. Similarly, our Board of Trustees is in a strong position right now in its composition, its diversity and its unity.

Another emphasis of the campaign has been a focus on academics and influencing the world of ideas. We are seeing momentum here as well. We have recently received full 10-year accreditation by the WASC Senior College and University Commission as well as the Association of Theological Schools — a very important endorsement of our academic strength!

Our three academic centers are thriving: the Center for Christian Thought, the Center for Christianity, Culture and the Arts, and the Center for Marriage and Relationships. Another center focused on the work and power of the Holy Spirit (see page 7) is set to launch this year.

Our faculty gets stronger every year, and this fall we welcomed 15 talented Christian scholars with graduate degrees from places like Stanford, Harvard, Durham, UC Berkeley and the University of Basel. They join a robust faculty with scholars who have come to Biola from prestigious universities all over the world, from Boston to Oxford and beyond.

Across our eight schools we are seeing innovation in program development and dramatic growth in online education, spurred on by the campaign's investment in technology and global reach. Our global student population has grown and our roster of online programs is expanding, with three new fully online master's degree programs launching in Talbot School of Theology in 2017, and others following in subsequent years. With the Biola Startup Competition and Praxis Academy, the Crowell School of Business is raising the profile of Biola as a hub of business entrepreneurship. Our Torrey Honors Institute and graduate apologetics and philosophy programs are internationally respected, and two of our philosophy professors — William Lane Craig and J.P. Moreland — were recently included on a list of the "50 Most Influential Living Philosophers."

Exciting things are also happening in athletics, with our move to join the NCAA Division II on track. We will become a provisional member of the NCAA in 2017–18

***The Campaign for Biola University** successfully raised more than \$214 million! Here are just a few tangible examples of how the funding is already being used to make a difference at Biola:*



**\$53.2M**

ENDOWED & RESTRICTED  
SCHOLARSHIPS



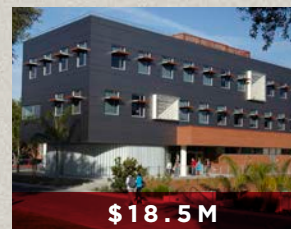
**\$29.8M**

BIOLA FUND & OTHER  
CURRENT INITIATIVES



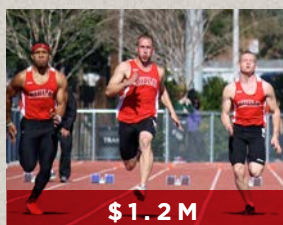
**\$38.7M**

CENTER FOR SCIENCE,  
TECHNOLOGY & HEALTH



**\$18.5M**

TALBOT EAST



**\$1.2M**

BIOLA ATHLETICS



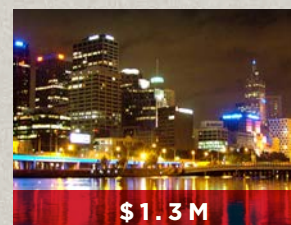
**\$6.7M**

CAMPUS IMPROVEMENTS



**\$10M**

CINEMA & MEDIA ARTS



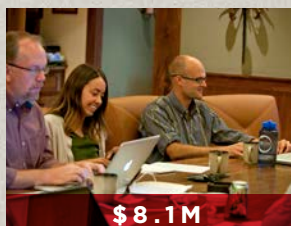
**\$1.3M**

INTERNATIONAL PROGRAMS  
AND GLOBAL REACH



**\$9.7M**

ACADEMIC CENTERS



**\$8.1M**

FACULTY RESEARCH



**\$36.8M**

SECURING BIOLA'S FUTURE  
(ESTATE GIFTS)



**\$214**  
MILLION  
*Grand Total*

and should gain full membership by 2019–20. Our student-athletes are excelling and our athletics staff is stronger than ever, led by Athletic Director Bethany Miller.

There is much more that could be said about the momentum we are seeing at Biola these days. In my 10 years of leading Biola I have never been more optimistic about the future. I've said it often this year and I mean it: *Biola's best days are yet to come.*

## STRENGTH FOR THE FUTURE

Biola University is in a strong position in 2017. We are academically strong. We are spiritually strong. We are fiscally strong, thanks in large part to the generosity of many of you who have given to our campaign. But as we

look to the future and build on strength, our need for investors will be greater than ever.

Affordability remains a top priority for us. We are committed to prioritizing programs and reducing costs to ensure Biola tuition increases are minimal. We are committed to streamlining degree programs, moving to a new year-round academic calendar and prioritizing student success initiatives to ensure faster graduation rates and minimal student debt. We are committed to thinking creatively about alternate revenue sources so that our budget does not depend as much on the tuition payments of students.

Another key part in our affordability efforts is the Biola Fund. With a goal of more than \$3 million each year, this is a pool of privately donated money that goes toward expanding student scholarships, enhancing

the extracurricular experiences for our students, improving campus life and strengthening our academic core. As we move beyond The Campaign for Biola and consider the elements of our next comprehensive campaign, the Biola Fund is our fundraising priority. And we will need your help!

Thank you again for praying for Biola during this campaign. Thank you for donating. Thank you for reading! And thank you for continuing to believe in the importance of Biola University. Our mission is sacred, and the field is the world. The work continues, and we press on in faith. **B**

**Barry H. Corey** is the president of Biola University.

# Keeping the Momentum Going

*The newly launched Biola Fund will help provide a world-class education for all students*

After five years and \$214 million in donations, The Campaign for Biola University has officially come to an end. Through the generosity of Biola's supporters, the university's ambitious fundraising goals were not only met, but dramatically exceeded.

Now, as a way to continue the momentum begun by the campaign and to meet the ongoing goal of providing a world-class education for all students, the university is celebrating the creation of a new giving opportunity.

The newly relaunched Biola Fund will offer a way for donors to provide the most effective and most direct support for all of the university's students moving forward, said Amy Weaver, assistant director of annual giving. With an ongoing annual goal of more than \$3 million, the Biola Fund is now the highest fundraising priority and will play a significant role in making Biola more affordable.

"We're thrilled to celebrate the completion of the campaign, but we know that the work of making and keeping Biola affordable for all students is never fully done," Weaver said. "The launch of our new Biola Fund is the answer to the ongoing question of affordability as we continue the work of carrying on the Biola tradition of biblically centered education for generations to come."

In giving to the Biola Fund, donors now have the option of choosing to designate their gifts toward one of four categories: student scholarships, student development, academic innovation or campus renewal. Formerly, the previous version of the fund allowed donors to support students more indirectly by offsetting annual operating costs. The change gives supporters a better sense of how their gifts are making a tangible difference and helping to keep tuition costs lower for every student, Weaver said.

And every gift counts, Weaver emphasized. More than 66 percent of the alumni and friends who support the Biola Fund on an annual basis do so with a gift under \$250. Whether large or small, each contribution goes to work immediately with the gifts of others to sustain the Biola experience for all students, she said.

"We believe that every student should have access to a world-class, biblically centered and academically rich education," Weaver said. "The Biola Fund provides the necessary resources to sustain this unique experience for more than 6,000 current graduate and undergraduate students without compromising the integrity and value of a Biola education."

— JASON NEWELL

## The Biola Fund: Providing a World-Class Education For All Students

*The new Biola Fund allows donors to support students by designating a gift to their choice of four categories. To support the fund, visit [giving.biola.edu/biolafund](http://giving.biola.edu/biolafund) or use the envelope enclosed in this issue of the magazine.*



### Student Scholarships

Designating your Biola Fund gift to student scholarships will provide financial assistance to students in need, many of whom are first-generation college students, come from lower-income families and face significant financial challenges.



### Student Development

Biola aims to equip students in mind and character to impact the world. Supporting the student development category will provide dynamic on-campus immersion experiences and learning opportunities to help students thrive as they pursue God's calling on their lives.



### Academic Innovation

Biola's world-class faculty are the core to our academic strength. Designating your gift to the academic innovation category will support leading faculty research, biblically based scholarship and the creation of new academic programs.



### Campus Renewal

A gift to the campus renewal category will help provide industry-leading classrooms and technology, living spaces, learning and study environments, community gathering spaces and campus grounds to support the educational experience.



# ***The Art of Relationships***

*Through its popular podcast, blog and events, Biola's Center for Marriage and Relationships is reaching thousands with practical, biblical wisdom*

*By Kathryn Toombs*



It's easy to idealize marriage. A few short weeks after their wedding, Miles and Aimee Matias ('16) realized just how true this was, as they began to encounter their own selfishness in its ugliest form.

"We thought that marriage was there to benefit us as individuals and not to challenge us as a couple," Aimee said. "We were no longer living to serve one another, but to serve ourselves."

The couple found themselves at each other's throats, struggling to communicate and constantly bickering. At their wit's end, they decided to look for help, and Aimee, then a student at Biola, remembered a new resource available to them — the Center for Marriage and Relationships. They attended their first marriage conference in October of 2016, and met with Chris and Alisa Grace, the directors of the center, to discuss how they could better communicate as a couple.

The impact was almost immediate. Miles and Aimee began to practice the techniques they had been given, and noticed a significant change in their relationship.

"Our communication skills have drastically changed for the better," Aimee said. "I'm happy to say that because of it we are able to love each other more fiercely, and push each other to walk humbly for our God ... In each other, not only have we fully discovered the love and grace that God bestows upon us, but we have also found our best friend."

## Relationally Minded

Since opening its doors in July of 2014, Biola's Center for Marriage and Relationships (CMR) has had a simple but powerful mission: relationships as ministry. And after three years of stories like Miles and Aimee's, the success of this center has become a testimony to the relevance of its central idea.

At the helm of the center are Chris and Alisa Grace, a husband and wife team respectively serving as director and consulting director. For these two, the creation of the center was not a revolutionary idea, but the result of a lifelong interest and passion for God-centered, healthy relationships and marriages. The pair have been involved in marriage ministry for over 25 years, and the opportunity to create a center devoted to the topic seemed to come at just the right time, at a university that was primed to embrace it.

"Biola has always been committed to relationships," said Chris Grace, a longtime Biola administrator and professor at Biola's Rosemead School of Psychology. "We've just been able to bring together some of the key ideas and thoughts and energy and do a center that way. ... I think we've just tapped into something that's pretty important and big, and we have great resources here at Biola."

From the start, the Center for Marriage and Relationships has set its sights on reaching the broader culture — not just Biola's students and campus. While providing in-house services like drop-in relationship advice, premarital referrals and counseling, relationship retreats and conferences, marriage mentorship and training opportunities for influencers, mentors and pastors in the area, the center has also actively worked to extend its reach.

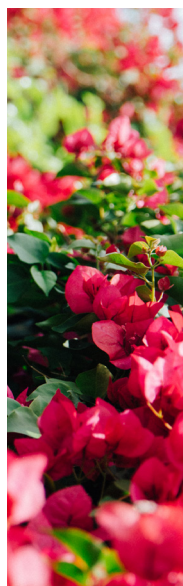
Working alongside Tim Muehlhoff, a communications professor at Biola, the minds behind the CMR have worked to bring these resources to the wider community through conferences and talks held both on and off campus.

"Relationships cut across all humans and spectrums, because we all want to be connected and emotionally together with somebody," Chris Grace said. "So when we go talk about how to communicate well and do relationships well, everybody wants to hear about it."

Most recently, the center has started expanding its platform to secular campuses. In October, Grace and Muehlhoff gave an open lecture at UC Berkeley sponsored by Cru (formerly Campus Crusade for Christ) titled, "How to Communicate and Be Successful: Tools for Growth in Relationships."

The event was a huge success. According to UC Berkeley's Cru directors, it was the largest turnout they'd had in recent history.

"One of our biggest challenges at Cal is ... finding events that spark interest in the spiritually non-interested," said Dan Goodson, Cru director at Berkeley. "This presentation saw the



largest number of non-Christians we've had at an event in the past three years, and we've been able to share the gospel with a number of them during our follow up."

The team has since been scheduled to present similar events this fall at UC Irvine and Yale University.

## A Universal Need

According to Chris Grace, the topic of relationships is a powerful ministry, both in Christian and non-Christian settings.

"It gets the gospel to people. I think it hits people at the heart," Grace said. "They want to be listened to and heard, and when they are, they realize that what we're doing is sharing the secret of how to know our Savior — his redeeming, caring love for us, and that's timeless. ... Start with your relationship with who God is, and it's going to minister to your marriage and to your relationships."

After holding a conference last year for firefighters and their spouses, six people came to Christ. And it didn't stop there. In the last six months, 12 people have come to Christ through the center's conferences on marriage and relationships.

"Marriage and relationships are the vehicle we use to get the gospel out there, because it's so needed," Alisa Grace said. "And I think the ultimate idea is, if we can help couples have a healthy, robust, satisfying, God-honoring marriage and relationship, that would be a winsome testimony to the world. And that would give them a platform of credibility to stand on to share the gospel with nonbelievers."

As the center continues expanding its ministry to Christians and non-Christians alike, the Graces hold that their goal remains the same: to meet a universal need.

"Our heart is to reach those who aren't traditionally reached by good, biblically centered, foundational relationship advice and skills," said Chris Grace. "The need is so great that people really seek wise voices, and we want to be that biblically centered wise voice, whether we present it to a Christian audience or a non-Christian audience."

One of the center's most recent initiatives is its "Neighbor Love" conferences. Intended to take the center's marriage

# RESOURCES FOR RELATIONSHIPS

*The center provides practical resources for anyone seeking healthier marriages and relationships, including:*



## ONLINE MEDIA RESOURCES

including lectures, podcasts, interviews, articles, videos and more



## EVENTS

including relationship retreats, marriage conferences and seminars at locations across the nation



## PREMARITAL COUNSELING

and education, marriage mentoring and referrals



## TRAINING OPPORTUNITIES

for influencers, mentors, pastors and leaders

conference sessions and resources to places where the need is greatest, the first “Neighbor Love” conference, titled “Marriage: Fan the Flame,” was held on Feb. 18 in Detroit, Mich., in partnership with Evangel Ministries and five local churches. The center’s speaking team was joined by Crawford Loritts, senior pastor at Fellowship Bible Church in Georgia and a FamilyLife conference speaker.

“We want to do this in different settings and locations,” Chris Grace said. “It’s for people who don’t have access. The issue isn’t only about economics. It’s about those who are least served. There are populations of people in our country who don’t have access to information about healthy relationships, and that includes Berkeley students; that includes inner- and outer-city folks; that includes those in the suburbs or in a penthouse. And we want to go there.”

## A Growing Voice

As the center seeks to expand its influence via conferences and lectures around the country, it continues to project its voice from Biola’s campus through its many online resources, including a podcast recorded and hosted by Chris Grace and Muehlhoff.

The podcast, a biweekly series in which the two discuss hot-button topics regarding marriage, relationships and spirituality, has received an overwhelmingly positive response. With episodes like “Navigating the Ambiguity of Dating,” “Cohabitation: Why Not Live Together?” and “4 Ways Culture Impacts Relationships,” the center reaches a wide online audience, averaging more than 1,000 downloads per episode, with the most popular episodes reaching more than 1,800 downloads. Through the podcast, the center’s team has been able to gauge not only what topics Biola students are interested in, but which questions people all over the country are asking.

Beyond the podcast, the center has strived to provide an abundance of resources for dating, engaged and married couples, as well as relationship advice for singles.

The center grew from ministering face-to-face with upwards of 2,500 people in their first year to over 5,000 individuals and couples in the next, via marriage conferences, marriage mentoring training, one-on-one counseling, Biola’s Christian relationships class, drop-in hours for relationship advice and various speaking events.

Included in these face-to-face ministering opportunities was the center’s first Marriage Mentoring Training Conference in the spring of 2015, featuring a new 72-page marriage curriculum book co-written by the Graces and Muehlhoff, with over 150 local leaders and pastors in attendance.

As the minds behind this growing force for healthy relationships and marriages within the Biola community and around the country look to the future, they firmly believe the work they’re doing has an eternal impact, and one which has only succeeded because of its root in Christ, they said.

“That’s what we hope to do for the next few years: push the boundaries,” said Chris Grace. “Because we believe in what we have. When you have a biblical foundation of wisdom and God’s truth that speaks into relationships, and you do that with good, healthy science and relationship skills and healthy perspectives from respectable academics, and you combine those in a practical way ... it’s a powerful package.” **B**



## THE ART OF RELATIONSHIPS

*Five Episodes to Download from  
“The Art of Relationships” Podcast*

- 1 DEALING WITH HOT BUTTON ISSUES
- 2 THE TOP THREE TYPES OF COMPATIBILITY ISSUES
- 3 DEALING WITH HOLIDAY STRESS
- 4 CONFLICT AND “MARITAL AFFAIRS”
- 5 THE ART OF GOOD LISTENING

*Find these episodes and more at  
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TO MAKE A DONATION IN SUPPORT OF THE CENTER FOR MARRIAGE AND RELATIONSHIPS, VISIT THE CENTER’S WEBSITE AT **CMR.BIOLA.EDU**.



# alumni life

## Careers, Callings & Community

- Meet the six recipients of the 2017 Alumni Awards
- Robin Jones Gunn ('75) shares the gospel through fiction
- After a historic campaign, what's next for the alumni office?



## ALUMNI PROFILE

# Creating 'Baby Believers'

Danielle Hitchen ('10) kickstarts a theology book for toddlers

Danielle Hitchen ('10) knows that raising kids is hard. As the mom of a 3-year-old and a 1-year-old, Hitchen is well aware of the challenges that come with motherhood. But about a year ago, Hitchen found herself facing a task she never anticipated having to tackle so early: her kids' spiritual formation.

After a conversation with a friend in which she was asked about what she was doing in regards to her daughter's spiritual formation, Hitchen's first response was a lighthearted one.

"Oh, you know, keeping her alive," she laughed.

But as she continued to talk with this friend, the idea gnawed at her. What was she doing for her daughter's spiritual formation? How does one begin to teach a small child about the complex tenets of the Christian faith?

Hitchen began to wonder if a book existed that served as a kid-friendly introduction to Christian theology. She began to search for one, but found nothing. Shocked that a tool like this wasn't already in existence, Hitchen decided that she would create one herself.

So began Hitchen's journey of bringing to life *Bible Basics: A Baby Believer Counting Primer*, a board book designed to teach babies, toddlers and preschoolers the central tenets of the Christian faith through counting.

"That was one of the goals of this book — to just make it less intimidating for parents to be able to introduce their kids to the foun-

dational concepts of the Christian faith," said Hitchen, who hopes the book provides a framework for parents to teach their kids abstract concepts in an approachable way.

Hitchen's pastor connected her with another mom in her area, illustrator Jessica Blanchard, and the two began a Kickstarter campaign to get their project off the ground. Within 24 hours, they were already two-thirds of the way to their goal. Four days later, they had met it.

*Bible Basics* was officially funded by Kickstarter on Sept. 29, 2016, exceeding the \$14,000 goal by more than double, with \$35,600 raised, and paving the way for the future success of Catechesis Books, a publishing company created by Hitchen specifically with her "Baby Believer" series in mind.

"Thanks to your generosity, we are also able to produce a printable download of 'Bible Basics' coloring pages, a hard copy 'Bible Basics' coloring book, AND have enough funds to begin development and production on a second 'Baby Believer Primer,'" Hitchen wrote on Kickstarter. "WOW!"

Hitchen credits her time at Biola as instilling in her the importance of a strong theological foundation.

"I think one of the reasons I care so deeply about my children's spiritual formation is because of my time at Biola and in [the] Torrey [Honors Institute]," said Hitchen. "Because of Biola, I know how meaningful it is to be deeply and intelligently rooted in the faith."

— KATHRYN TOOMBS



**MARGARET SANDERS RECENTLY CELEBRATED HER 90TH BIRTHDAY**

## CLASS NOTES

**Margaret (Bascom, '48) Sanders** recently celebrated her 90th birthday, and was joined for the occasion by her sister Barbara Bascom ('38) and niece Barbara Bryant ('67). Margaret and Al ('49) have been married 68 years and live in Newport Beach, Calif. They continue to be active in ministry in a variety of ways, including Margaret's musicianship at the keyboard, which was part of her birthday festivities.

**Walt Shannon ('69)** recently retired from the California Water Resources Control Board, where he was a senior engineer. Shannon is married to Aimme Argonia, and they attend the Filipino Fellowship at Creekside Christian Church in Elk Grove. The pair are active in supporting various missions outreaches in the Philippines.

**Dave ('70, M.A. '73) and Joanne ('71) Beckwith** recently published the book *The Edge: God's Power Perfected in Weakness*. In the book, the two encourage readers to sharpen their edges in life as they discover why God designed humanity with built-in weaknesses, and how he perfects his power in our inadequacies, failures and frailties. In this six-week personal growth journey, readers are able to dig into God's Word to discover how to transform their minds, release resentments and regrets, and deepen

relationships through an understanding of strengths and weaknesses.

**Aaron Zapata ('96)**, the founder and CEO of IMPACT Properties in Orange County, recently expanded his business into Los Angeles County with the opening of a new office in La Mirada.

**Tom Gender (M.A. '06)** recently published the book *Rethinking Genesis One: A Layman's Guide to the First Page of the Bible*. In the book, Gender draws on his experience in the field of Christian apologetics, aiming to alleviate some of the consternation, confusion and conflict among Christians and non-Christians in regards to this famous passage.

**David Eastman ('08)** was recently elected to the Alaska House of Representatives as the representative for District 10. Eastman is a military veteran, firefighter for the Central Mat-Su Fire Department, member of the Alaska Disaster Medical Assistance Team and former military police officer. He resides in Wasilla with his wife, Jennifer, and their two children.

**Andrew Allwander ('09)** spent a year teaching adult ESL in Korea while training in taekwondo and earned his fourth-degree black belt and Master of Taekwondo certification from the prestigious Kukkiwon/World Taekwondo Academy, the world headquarters of taekwondo in Korea. He then became

instructor-certified in the Philippines from Ensayo Kali Tactical (Filipino stick and blade martial arts).

**Dennis Linthicum (M.A. '10)** was recently elected to the Oregon State Senate as the representative for District 28. Linthicum is a former Klamath County Commissioner, and a former senior vice president of management information systems at Lange Financial Corporation and Pacific Mutual Life Insurance. He and his wife, Diane, recently celebrated their 36th wedding anniversary, and the pair have two children who also reside in Oregon with their families.

**Philip ('11) and Ashley (Davenport, '10) Myers** recently celebrated the birth of their first baby. Elias Michael Myers was born on Feb. 23, 2016.

**Christina (Anderson '00, M.A. '12) and William Martinez** are proud to announce the birth of their baby girl, Zoe Iris, on March 4, 2016. She is eager to join her big brother Ezekiel in as many adventurous enterprises as possible. The family lives in Pomona, Calif., with Will working for Costco in Rancho Cucamonga and Christina working for a church lender in Brea.

**Chris ('12) and Megan Negrete ('09, M.A. '12)** brought their 2-year-old daughter, Noeline Margaret, home from Uganda in September 2016 after a lengthy adoption process. She

is adjusting and bonding well and is such a joy. She's already looking forward to becoming a Biola Eagle!

**Brittany (Watts, '12)** married **Nicholas Garner** on Oct. 9, 2016. The two reside in San Jose, Calif., where Brittany works as an artistic director and executive assistant at West Valley Dance Company.

**Adam Rechenmacher (M.A. '12)** recently released the book *Brilliant Colors*, a short fiction story addressing primal targets of human striving and several significant impairments to spiritual wholeness. The book was birthed out of his experience as a spiritual director, as he discovered recurring patterns of spiritual "stuck-ness."

**Robert Carlson ('15)** recently published the children's book *The Miniature Railroad*. Carlson is a graduate of Biola's cinema and media arts program and creates videos for the YouTube channel 5MadMovieMakers.

**Matt Tory ('15)** wrote and directed a comedy mockumentary film, *We Make Movies*, which is available to stream on Amazon. The feature film follows a group of friends who spend their summer making a movie for their town's film festival. Other Biola alumni involved in the making of the film include Robert Carlson ('15), Andrew Cobb ('16) and JJ Carroll ('14).



**DAVID EASTMAN WAS RECENTLY ELECTED TO THE ALASKA HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES**



**THE NEGRETE FAMILY ADOPTED NOELINE FROM UGANDA**



**DAVE AND JOANNE BECKWITH PUBLISHED THE EDGE**

## IN MEMORIAM

**N.T. Dellinger ('57, M.Div. '62)** passed away on Sept. 9, 2016. N.T. and his wife, Joy ('59, M.A. '63) served as missionaries in Central America for over 50 years, making their

residence in Belize. N.T. is survived by Joy and their two sons, Stephen and Jeffry.

**Joe Heffley ('73)**, a family man and owner of a successful real estate business in Colorado, passed away on Nov.

4, 2016. He is survived by his high school sweetheart, Vickie, his three children, Nicholas, Preston and Melinda, his grandchildren Hailey, Lauryn, Ethan and Lilly, great granddaughter Nellie, and his beloved dog, Peaches.

**Heath Graf ('96)** passed away on April 7, 2016. He was a servant of the Lord in North Africa, but was forced to leave that country for treatment of glioblastoma multiform. He is survived by his wife, Brandi, and daughters Erin, Carys and Sophia.

BIOLA UNIVERSITY  
**FOOTSTEPS OF  
PAUL  
GREECE TOUR**  
WITH PRESIDENT  
BARRY H. COREY



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Tour the beautiful seaside country of Greece and retrace the steps of the Apostle Paul as you watch the New Testament come alive in the very cities where Paul first preached the gospel of Jesus Christ to thousands. This land that is rich in history, culture and natural beauty offers much to explore and experience, and will deepen your understanding of the roots of the early Christian church and the gospel message.

Space is limited for this tour! For more information or to register, contact Sarah Epp at [sarah.epp@biola.edu](mailto:sarah.epp@biola.edu).

FROM THE ALUMNI OFFICE

## After a Historic Campaign, What's Next?

THE COMPLETION OF THE CAMPAIGN FOR BIOLA UNIVERSITY IS ONE OF the most significant accomplishments that I have experienced in my nearly four decades at Biola. Why? There are many reasons. The amount raised, \$214 million, was more than 10 times larger than the largest campaign we had ever previously completed, and well beyond what the experts and consultants said we should be able to raise. And we finished the five-year campaign on schedule! An impressive feat.

But what really amazed me about the campaign is how it helped galvanize an army of volunteers, alumni, parents, friends and donors, who rallied to the cause of making Biola the university God wants us to be, and preparing our students and graduates with conviction and courage to be what God wants them to be! I've never seen anything like this before at Biola University and I am so proud of our alumni, parents and friends!

So, what do we do now that this campaign is complete and we have thousands of donors and volunteers saying "what's next?" Well, good news! The work is not done and we are ready to take your enthusiasm and energy to the next level. Here's some of what's new and coming soon:

- **Regional Alumni Community Events.** We have 10 cities across the country where local alumni will coordinate regional events and "Backyard Biola" summer events. We can't wait to see you!
- **Coffee Breaks and Regional Career Conversations** between alumni and students. Now in its second year, this is a great chance for students to meet alumni for career-specific exploratory conversations. Looking for a great intern? This is your chance to meet Biola students in your hometown!
- **Monthly E-newsletters.** Whether you are a young alumnus or a more seasoned veteran, these audience-specific email newsletters will keep you in the know about the great things happening on campus!
- **Alumni Chapel and Alumni Reunions.** Plan to head back to your alma mater for Alumni Weekend on June 23–25, 2017, for amazing campus events and reunions.
- **Golden Eagle Chapel and Coffee.** Calling all alumni who graduated 50 years or more ago! Each semester you will be invited back to campus for a Friday chapel and coffee in the Heritage Café. We are celebrating you and your heritage as Alumni for Life!

As an alumni office, it is our privilege to be your connection to the great things happening here at Biola. If you haven't been back to Biola in a while, we look forward to hosting you here. And if you can't get away, we look forward to seeing you where you live! There are exciting things coming for 2017 and we will see you soon! For together we are Alumni for Life!

**Rick Bee** ('79, M.A. '90, Ph.D. '01)

Senior Director of Alumni and Parent Relations  
[rick.bee@biola.edu](mailto:rick.bee@biola.edu)





## ALUMNI PROFILE

# The Mission of 'Christy Miller'

Robin Jones Gunn ('75) shares the gospel through fiction



To many young girls (and former young girls), the name Robin Jones Gunn is a familiar one. As the author of over 90 books, including the popular and well-loved *Christy Miller* series, Gunn ('75) has become well-known in both literary and evangelical circles.

During her time at Biola, however, Gunn was interested in a different type of storytelling. As a young adult, Gunn dreamed of going overseas and spreading the gospel. During her college years, she spent four months in Europe traveling and attending Capernwray Bible School, serving with an underground mission, and making two trips transporting hundreds of Bibles behind the Iron Curtain.

In her words she had a "missionary woman's heart," and it came as a great surprise to her that, after many attempts at applying for missions work overseas, she continued to be rejected.

It appeared that God had other plans.

Early in her marriage to Ross Gunn, a 1977 graduate of Biola's Talbot School of Theology, her husband recognized Gunn's knack for storytelling. He encouraged her to attend a writer's conference, and Gunn reluctantly decided to go, though she had low expectations.

"I thought maybe I could write a short devotion or an article that might be published," she said. "That was as far as I dared to dream. While at the conference I worked on a devotion for *The Upper Room* and it was accepted for publication a few weeks later. They paid me \$10."

Though pleased with her success in publishing a few articles and devotionals, Gunn didn't expect her writing career to expand much further. However, her perspective shifted once again on a camping trip with her church youth group. After expressing dismay at the content of what she saw the young girls in her tent reading, the girls told her that if she didn't like it, *she* should write something for them to read. This sparked the idea for Christy Miller, a character who would introduce young girls to edifying stories about love, relationships, faith and growing up.

"It took two years to write the first *Christy Miller* book and those girls were brutal with their critiquing," Gunn said. "I kept rewriting until it became the story they wanted to read."

After a series of harsh critiques from both her young focus group, and a string of rejections from different publishers, the first *Chris-*

*ty Miller* book was picked up by Focus on the Family Publishers in 1988. Almost immediately, Gunn began to see that the response to her books was something with real, eternal impact.

"A few weeks after the first book released we received a letter from a young girl who said she 'prayed along with Christy' as she was reading *Summer Promise* and gave her life to the Lord," she said. "Since that first letter I have received thousands from girls all over the world who have come to know Christ through the role models in these novels."

The *Christy Miller* series has since expanded to 20 novels, and has been followed by the *Sierra Jensen* series and the *Katie Weldon* series. In total, over 4 million copies of Gunn's stories have been sold.

Thirty years after being rejected for the position of a laundry supervisor in Kenya, Gunn found herself at an international writers conference in England. She met a young woman there from Nairobi who had read her books as a teen.

"I told her how when I was her age, I thought I was going to go to Kenya and wash clothes for Jesus," said Gunn. "After she stopped laughing, she told me, 'You did not need to come to Africa to wash our laundry. You sent your stories and they have washed our hearts.'"

To a woman who throughout her life had dreamed of spreading the gospel, these words carried immeasurable weight.

"That's when I began to see how God's ways really aren't our ways," Gunn said. "He planted the 'missionary woman' dream in my heart but he was accomplishing it in his way."

Gunn has continued to be in awe of God's work through her stories. In November 2016, the film adaption of her novel *Finding Father Christmas* premiered on Hallmark Channel, and the next installment in her popular Christy Miller series, *Christy and Todd: The Baby Years*, is in the works.

To Gunn, her life has been a testament to God's working, both in ways we anticipate, and ways we could never have expected.

"I eventually willingly did what I was created to do — tell stories," Gunn said. "I guess I became a missionary after all. Just not the way I thought I would during my years at Biola."

— KATHRYN TOOMBS



# Meet the 2017 Alumni Award Winners

The Biola University Alumni Board is pleased to announce the recipients of the 2017 Alumni Awards. Awardees will be honored during a special program and dinner on June 24 as part of Alumni Weekend. Everyone is invited to attend. For registration, email [alumni.awards@biola.edu](mailto:alumni.awards@biola.edu) or call the alumni office at (562) 903-4728.

## Young Alumnus Award

Luke Glaze ('07) started the social business Green Creations ([greencreationsjo.com](http://greencreationsjo.com)) in Jordan in 2009. The business provides employment for women in poverty, educates the community on environmental issues and helps provide a community where the love of God is experienced. After six years, Glaze, who earned his degree in intercultural studies from Biola, returned to his hometown of Salem, Ore., and is launching another business, Sparrow Furniture ([sparrowfurniture.org](http://sparrowfurniture.org)), to provide transitional employment to the increasing refugee population as they learn English and build their resumes with practical skills. He and his wife, Jocelyn ('06), have two children.

## Clyde Cook Missions Award

Allan "Lanny" Arensen ('71) served with Africa Inland Mission (AIM) for over 40 years, first as a missionary to East Africa and later as the international director of AIM. Before retiring to Colorado, Arensen and his wife had the responsibility to recruit, screen and prepare missionary candidates in their pilgrimage to Africa. They cared for the financial and administrative details for members and raised awareness in churches, schools and other groups. Over the course of their ministry, the Arensens served in 15 different countries: Chad, Central Africa Republic, Democratic Republic of Congo, Rwanda, South Sudan, Uganda, Angola, Island of the Indian Ocean, Lesotho, Madagascar, Mayotte, Mozambique, Namibia, Kenya and Tanzania.

## Cultural Impact Award

Mark Joseph ('90) is an award-winning film and music producer, author and founder/CEO of MJM Entertainment Group and Bully! Pulpit Records. Over the course of his career, Joseph has worked in the development and marketing of 40 films, including *The Chronicles of Narnia*, *Ray*, *Holes*, *Because of Winn Dixie*, *Son of God* and *Little Boy*, and served as producer for the award-winning soundtrack for *The Passion of The Christ*. He is co-founder and a member of the board of directors of the Damah Film Festival and the Hiroshima International Film Festival, and is the author of four books. He lives in Southern California with his wife and five children.

## Lifetime Achievement Award

Anne Abajian Sandoval ('48) was born in Los Angeles to Armenian immigrants and spent her early adult years helping to build the P-38 aircraft during World War II. After attending Biola, where she was active in student leadership, Sandoval married and served in ministry alongside a young pastor, playing an integral role in building Sunday school programs. When her husband died soon after being recruited to build the new Christian education department at Western Seminary in Portland, Ore., the seminary's leadership asked Sandoval to take his place. She dedicated the next 25 years to teaching and leading in the department. In 1977, Sandoval was the first woman to receive an honorary doctorate from Biola. At 93, she is still active with her church, community and family.

## Cultural Impact Award

Shelley Leith ('80) is the national director of church relations for Zondervan, and her training courses and resources have helped more than 10,000 churches implement year-long intergenerational discipleship programs such as *The Story* and *Believe*. She previously served on staff at Saddleback Church, where she developed church training materials for the 40 Days of Purpose campaign, used in over 30,000 churches. She is the author of *Character Makeover* and *Head to Soul Makeover*, and speaks across the country on character, self-esteem, marriage and motherhood. Leith and her husband of 37 years, Greg ('78), live in Southern California and have five children, all Biola alumni.

## Rosemead Alumni Award

Col. Jay Earles (Psy.D. '94) is the chief of the Department of Behavioral Health at Dwight D. Eisenhower Army Medical Center (DDE-AMC), the president of the American Board of Clinical Health Psychology, and a former clinical psychology consultant to the Army surgeon general. At DDEAMC, Earles leads five outpatient behavioral health clinics and two inpatient programs, provides clinical services, supervises psychology interns and residents, teaches didactics and supports the center's behavioral health research mission. Over the course of his training and career, he has served the Army in a range of roles and has co-authored scientific papers and a book chapter. He and his wife, Kim, have two children and are active members of their church.

# Appetite for Construction

Property developer Jeff Hachquet ('00) turned family land into food-lovers' destination

During nearly 15 years in real estate development, Jeff Hachquet ('00) has worked with properties across Las Vegas. But no project has been as fulfilling — or as delicious — as welcoming two food-lovers' destinations to a plot of North Las Vegas land that has belonged to his family for decades.

In October 2016, Hachquet celebrated a years-in-the-making opening of a Cracker Barrel on his family's property just off Interstate 15, where it joined an In-N-Out Burger that opened six years earlier. In a relatively short span of time, the two iconic restaurant chains — the latter known for its West Coast roots and the former known for being in most parts of the country *except* for the West Coast — have made the family's long-empty land into a destination for locals and passing-through travelers alike. They've also been a particularly satisfying business accomplishment for Hachquet, a Biola communications studies graduate with an emphasis in advertising.

During the day, Hachquet manages commercial real estate for SK+G, an advertising agency in Las Vegas. And for the last decade, he has used his off hours to bring together his passions for his family's land, his background in advertising and his experience in property development.

Shortly after 9/11, Hachquet lost his advertising job in southern California and moved home to Las Vegas. While working in advertising for a small real estate developer, he asked the owner to mentor him in more aspects of the business. After several years learning the ins and outs of com-

mercial real estate, he began his current job at SK+G.

But long before Hachquet's interest in real estate, his grandfather, Eddie Morgan, bought up land around the Las Vegas valley in hopes of developing them one day. After Morgan's death from pancreatic cancer in 1988, some parcels were eventually sold, but Hachquet inherited his grandfather's vision for what remained.

Over the years, when Hachquet wasn't managing SK+G's properties, he sought out ground leases for his grandparents' land. In 2007, he and his mom crafted a solicitation to Cracker Barrel encouraging them to look at the land. Cracker Barrel declined, and they declined again in 2010, but the family was encouraged when In-N-Out Burger signed a lease.

Hachquet continued working his day job, raising his children with his wife, Amy (Dye, '02), and pursuing development deals. In 2014, as the family prepared to sign a lease with another tenant, Cracker Barrel called. Within four hours they had an offer, and in October 2016 the first Cracker Barrel in North Las Vegas opened and quickly became their second busiest location nationwide.

"For me, this is a way to continue my grandpa's legacy," said Hachquet, who is still looking for one final tenant to add to the property. "It's allowing me to be a steward of what God has blessed our family with. God has a plan, and he brings the right people in, if you just surrender to him."

— KRISTEN HARTMAN

## OPEN SPOTS ON THE ALUMNI BOARD!

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as alumni? Biola's  
Alumni Board is  
looking for passionate  
individuals who want to  
serve the university and  
represent the interests of  
its alumni.*

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for more information.



COURTESY OF JEFF HACHQUET

*Alumni  
for life.*



## A College on the Move

"The realization of new buildings long planned for, the expansion of the college curriculum, a sizable increase in the student body, new additions to the faculty." Though it sounds like it could refer to Biola University in 2017, this is how the 1967 *Biolan* yearbook described Biola College a half-century ago, "a college very much on the move." This aerial photo shows how the growing campus looked back then. Can you spot and name all the buildings in the photo?

 send us your class notes!

Did you land a new job? Finish another degree? Publish a book? Get married? Have a baby? Retire?

*We'd love to hear what you've been up to. So send us your update of up to 60 words, and be sure to include your year(s) of graduation or last year you attended Biola. We'll get your news into the next available issue.*

### EMAIL

biolamag@biola.edu

### MAIL

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13800 Biola Avenue  
La Mirada, CA 90639

# the last word

## Local Politics:

The Hard Road to Love and Humility in Your Neighborhood

**W**E FOLLOW CHRIST. WE WANT TO be active American citizens. In this day and age and in this culture of outrage, can we be both of those people at the same time? You see, this is something I struggle with on a day-to-day basis because — well, don't hold this against me — I'm an elected official and I love Jesus.

As people who follow Christ, *how* we participate in the political process and *how* we lead when we have the opportunity matters.

At every online turn, there are opportunities to defame, criticize and offend. The schoolyard bully has become a grown-up and he is now the social media rock star! Then there are haters who want to be on TV so they attend city council meetings. Every two weeks I subject myself to all manner of criticism, some more constructive than others. I'm belittled, I'm questioned and second-guessed, I'm accused of being in the pocket of special interests, my job as a public relations consultant is smeared and my faith is called into question. I've learned that as soon as one is elected to public office, one by default becomes an idiot of the highest proportion. Tough lesson to learn. If I happen to find allies in local government from across the political aisle then I'm a turncoat, a castoff from my political party. Just how am I supposed to cope with these oppressive influences and honor God in the process? Ah ... my favorite prayer comes to mind: "God,

please don't let me embarrass you."

Look, it may not be pretty, but it's where I am. And where are you? Where is our humility, our other-centeredness, our grace being born out in the world of politics? Are we so full of ourselves that we have forgotten that we're all in the same hell-bound position but for the abundant grace and relentless pursuit of our God?

Hear me, God is in control. He is working mightily in my community and all over this world, but too often it's in spite of his followers. We think we need to back a presidential candidate because the fate of the world hangs in the balance! We think Jesus cares about high-density housing and public employee pensions! We question each other's faith when we disagree on these and many other issues. I'm not saying those things aren't important, but of highest importance? Give me a break! We all know what our Savior cares about. He came to set the captives free. He came to give abundant life, he came to care for widows and orphans and bring an everlasting hope. And he invited us to join him.

I joined him in my community as a member of our city council, and for the last four years I've had a front row seat as he's healed divisions in our community, united our community in love for each other, brought dignity back to our people as they've loved their neighbors as themselves. I stand in awe of our God as I see disparate people in just the

right position to all enable God's work in the hearts of our residents; reconnecting the disconnected and taking hopelessness and turning it right into hope.

Tonight I read a Facebook post from a professing Christian who railed against me, my job and my service on the city council. He called my faith into question, calling me a wolf in sheep's clothing. My initial thought was that I've never met this person. They claim Jesus, as I do, and yet instead of reach out personally to me, they went online to beg people to vote against me in this election. How often do each of us take action like that, without personal knowledge, without facts, guided only by the allegations of others. I'm called to something other than that, higher than that. God calls me to love people above all. That has to apply to politics and it has to characterize our political engagement or we are no different than the world.

Jesus stood out like a sore thumb in his community and that's my new prayer starting right now, that I do too. I pray that as they hurl insults at me I make way for Jesus. Won't you do that too? Commit to engaging in politics to further Jesus' goals ... to set the captives free, to care for widows and orphans, to bring light to a dark world. At no other time has our world so longed for radical love and hope. If we don't point them to it through our grace and radical kindness ... no one will.

This issue's Last Word comes from The Table, the blog of the Center for Christian Thought. This article is adapted from a post that first appeared on November 2, 2016.

**Jennifer Fitzgerald** ('95), was elected to the Fullerton City Council in November 2012, and served as mayor during the 2016 year. She spoke at the Biola University Center for Christian Thought's 2016 Table Conference on "Love and Humility in Politics."



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A photograph of an elderly couple, a man and a woman, smiling and looking at a tablet together. The man is on the left, wearing a purple checkered shirt, and the woman is on the right, wearing a pink shirt. They are both looking at the tablet with interest and joy.

## WHAT LEGACY WILL YOU LEAVE?

As a follower of Christ, you want your life to make a difference for God's kingdom. But what impact will you continue to make when your life is finished?

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